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# Toothwise: A YOLO-Based Multi-Condition Dental Screening System with KNN-Based Recommendation for CodiSmile Dental Clinic

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**CAPSTONE 2**

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## ABSTRACT

Dental screening at CodiSmile Dental Clinic relies on visual inspection, which makes early tartar, plaque, cavity, and gum inflammation hard to detect consistently, leaves no standardized visual record, and gives patients little finding-specific guidance. This study developed Toothwise, a web-based screening support system that detects these four conditions and healthy tooth in still intraoral photographs with a fused YOLOv8 and YOLOv12 ensemble, computes a 0–100 risk score and a low, medium, or high risk tier, and generates a personalized prevention plan with a K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) classifier. The system was developed with an Agile methodology using React, FastAPI, and PostgreSQL, and deployed on cloud hosting. On a held-out test set of 2,930 images, YOLOv8 reached an mAP@50 of 51.91% and YOLOv12 48.11%, and the fused ensemble 54.24%; cavity was detected best and plaque worst. The KNN classifier reproduced the clinical risk rule with 92.75% accuracy on 2,000 unseen cases, and all 119 automated backend tests passed. The system was evaluated through an online questionnaire answered by 103 respondents (98 patient respondents and 5 IT experts) on a four-point scale. The six ISO/IEC 25010 quality characteristics (security, privacy, usability, reliability, performance efficiency, and data protection), rated by 12 respondents, obtained an overall weighted mean of 3.68, and the system's detection, results, and prevention-plan features, rated by all 103, obtained 3.48; both are interpreted as Highly Acceptable. The study concludes that Toothwise is an acceptable screening and documentation aid that supports, but does not replace, the dentist's diagnosis, and recommends more training data for weak classes such as plaque, the use of an intraoral camera for clearer images, a larger evaluation with dentists and clinic staff, and a controlled comparison of screening time and consistency.


***Keywords:*** dental screening, YOLOv8, YOLOv12, ensemble object detection, K-Nearest Neighbors, prevention plan, ISO/IEC 25010

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# CHAPTER I
# INTRODUCTION

## 1.1 Background of the Study

CodiSmile Dental Clinic currently relies on manual visual examination and professional judgment to identify dental caries and other visible dental conditions from patient examinations and intraoral images. Although this approach is essential to dental practice, manually reviewing images may be time-consuming and can result in variations in assessment and documentation. To support the existing process, the proponents propose Toothwise: A YOLO-Based Multi-Condition Dental Screening System with KNN-Based Recommendation for CodiSmile Dental Clinic, an AI-assisted system that analyzes intraoral images and detects possible dental conditions — tartar, plaque, cavity, gum inflammation, and healthy tooth — using the YOLOv12 and YOLOv8 object detection models. The system provides visual detection results, condition labels, descriptions, a computed risk classification, and preventive recommendations to assist dentists and improve patient understanding. Toothwise is intended to serve as a supplementary screening and documentation tool, while final interpretation and clinical decisions remain the responsibility of licensed dental professionals.

Dental caries, commonly referred to as tooth decay or cavities, remains one of the most prevalent non-communicable diseases in the world. The World Health Organization (2025) estimates that oral diseases affect nearly 3.7 billion people globally, with untreated dental caries in permanent teeth identified as the single most widespread health condition based on Global Burden of Disease 2021 data. Despite its prevalence, a significant portion of the population, particularly those in geographically isolated or economically disadvantaged communities, continues to face substantial barriers in accessing timely and adequate dental care. In the Philippines, Mendoza et al. (2025) note that an estimated 29 million Filipinos have untreated dental caries and that outpatient dental services were not covered by the PhilHealth benefit package at the time of their analysis. The financial cost

of consultations, the distance to dental facilities, and low oral health literacy frequently result in delayed care-seeking, by which point cavities have often advanced beyond their most treatable stages. Untreated caries does not just cause physical pain; Almajed et al. (2023) found that children with untreated caries had higher rates of poor oral-health-related quality of life.

A critical dimension of the current dental care challenge lies in the inconsistency of manual cavity screening practices. Wang et al. (2026), in a review on the clinical translation of AI-based caries diagnosis, noted that traditional diagnostic methods suffer from limited sensitivity and high variability between examiners, particularly for early-stage lesions. This inter-examiner variability is particularly problematic in high-volume clinic settings where practitioner fatigue and time pressure can further compromise screening reliability. Research has shown that deep learning models are capable of detecting dental cavities with accuracy that is on par with, or sometimes even better than, trained clinicians, as reported in the reviews by Schwendicke et al. (2019) and Mohammad-Rahimi et al. (2022). This makes AI a genuinely useful tool for supplementing human judgment during screenings.

Standard digital cameras and smartphone cameras have also changed the way dental screening can be supported outside specialized clinical equipment. Instead of relying purely on what a dentist can see with a mirror and a light, or requiring dedicated intraoral camera hardware, clear intraoral photographs can now be captured using widely available consumer devices. Park et al. (2022), for example, improved caries classification on intraoral camera photographs by first segmenting the tooth surfaces, and studies such as those by Moharrami et al. (2025) and Askar et al. (2021) show that RGB photographs captured under ordinary imaging conditions are detailed enough to support reliable artificial intelligence-based detection of dental conditions. It is this still-image, standard-camera modality that serves as the primary data source for Toothwise during patient screenings at CodiSmile Dental Clinic, since the system is designed to work from

photographs taken with an ordinary device camera, such as a smartphone, and uploaded to the system, rather than requiring a dedicated intraoral camera.

The AI model powering the primary detection module of this system is YOLOv12, which was introduced by Tian et al. (2025) as an attention-centric object detection framework. Compared to previous versions in the YOLO family, YOLOv12 uses area attention mechanisms that help it focus selectively on spatially relevant regions, something that happens regularly in dental images where carious lesions appear as small, low-contrast areas across multiple tooth surfaces simultaneously. Its combination of speed and accuracy makes it well-suited for efficient use during clinical consultations, where screening results need to be generated quickly enough to fit within a standard patient visit.

To evaluate whether YOLOv12's architectural improvements translate into meaningful gains for this specific screening task, this study also trains and evaluates YOLOv8, an earlier and widely adopted model in the YOLO family (Jocher et al., 2023). YOLOv8 has been applied in several prior dental imaging studies with strong results; de Brito et al. (2025) used YOLOv8 together with EfficientNet-B0 to diagnose caries in interproximal radiographic images of young permanent molars, and other work has applied YOLOv8's anchor-free detection mechanism to interproximal caries detection with improved accuracy and speed over earlier YOLO versions. This makes it a stable, well-benchmarked baseline for object detection tasks. While YOLOv12 and YOLOv8 are formally compared against each other using precision, recall, mAP, and inference speed on a held-out labeled test set, both models are also deployed together in the operational system, where their independent detection outputs are fused into a single clinical detection set. This dual approach allows the study to identify which architecture performs better on this specific task while still taking advantage of both models' detections in the deployed screening workflow.

Beyond detection, Toothwise also generates a personalized prevention plan for each patient based on their screening results. This is done using the K-Nearest Neighbors

(KNN) algorithm, a supervised learning method originally introduced by Cover and Hart (1967), which classifies a new case by comparing it against the most similar cases in a reference dataset. In this study, KNN classifies each screening into a risk tier (low, medium, or high) based on the patient's detected findings — condition type, number of affected areas, and severity indicators derived from the detection output — and this risk classification, together with condition-specific rules, is used to compose an ordered, patient-friendly prevention plan, while the 0–100 risk score itself comes from a separate rule-based formula. Since no dentist-labeled cases exist before deployment, the KNN is first trained on synthetic cases derived from the clinical severity rule, and each tier the dentist confirms or corrects is added as a real case for retraining.

While AI-assisted dental screening has grown internationally, its application in the Philippine setting remains an emerging area of research. Wu et al. (2025), in collaboration with Ateneo de Manila University's Laboratory for Intelligent Visual Environments, applied a deep learning model to identify tooth and sinus structures in dental panoramic radiographs, illustrating the early but growing interest in AI-assisted dental diagnostics locally. This study seeks to build on that emerging interest by applying AI-assisted screening directly within a clinic setting through Toothwise.

This project was created in partnership with CodiSmile Dental Clinic, which serves as the deployment site and clinical reference point throughout the study. The goal is not to take the place of the dentist but to give them a more efficient and objective tool to work with. With Toothwise integrated into the clinic's workflow, screenings can be documented more consistently, and patients can walk away with a clearer understanding of their oral health through the system's risk classification and personalized prevention plan features.

### 1.2 Statement of the Problem

Dental screening at CodiSmile Dental Clinic relies on visual inspection. Early-stage tartar, plaque, cavity, and gum inflammation are small, look similar to one another,

and vary with lighting, angle, and stage, so visual assessment is subjective and findings can differ between examinations. The clinic has no standardized visual record of findings to compare across visits, and patients are rarely given finding-specific preventive guidance. Undetected conditions can progress to pain, tooth loss, and costlier treatment, which makes consistent early screening a challenge of the method itself.

This study seeks to answer the following:

1. What limitations of visual-only screening make early-stage tartar, plaque, cavity, and gum inflammation and healthy tooth, as well as their relative severity, difficult to detect and distinguish consistently at CodiSmile Dental Clinic?
2. What gaps exist in how screening findings are recorded and made accessible to dentists and patients, given the absence of a standardized visual record and a way for patients to review their own history?
3. What barriers prevent patients from receiving timely, finding-specific preventive guidance after screening?
4. What is the level of acceptability of the Toothwise system in terms of the six ISO/IEC 25010 quality characteristics evaluated in this study (security, privacy, usability, reliability, performance efficiency, and data protection), as evaluated by IT experts and patient respondents?
5. How do the respondents assess the effect of Toothwise on screening consistency and screening time compared with the current manual process?

## 1.3 Objectives of the Study

### 1.3.1 General Objective:

To design, develop, and evaluate Toothwise, a dental screening support system that uses YOLO-based detection on still intraoral photographs, a KNN-based risk classification and recommendation feature, to provide consistent and accessible screening support for licensed dentists and patients at CodiSmile Dental Clinic.

### 1.3.2 Specific Objectives:

1. To train YOLOv12 and YOLOv8 on annotated still intraoral images to detect tartar, plaque, cavity, gum inflammation, and healthy tooth and compute an associated risk score and risk classification (low, medium, high) from the detected findings, and compare the two models by precision, recall, mAP, and inference speed.
2. To develop a results interface showing bounding boxes, condition labels, plain-language descriptions, and risk classification, with a per-patient record of findings across visits accessible to dentists and, through a self-service patient portal, to patients themselves.
3. To develop a KNN-based feature that generates a personalized prevention plan from the detected findings and computed risk classification.
4. To evaluate Toothwise using six ISO/IEC 25010 quality characteristics with IT experts and patient respondents.
5. To assess the effect of Toothwise on screening consistency and screening time compared with the current manual process.

## 1.4 Scope, Delimitation and Limitation of the Study

### Scope

This study covers the design, development, training, and evaluation of Toothwise, an AI-assisted dental screening support system for CodiSmile Dental Clinic. Using still photographs taken with a standard device camera, such as a smartphone, and uploaded to the system as JPEG, PNG, or WebP files, Toothwise analyzes the patient's teeth and gums to detect five classes: tartar, plaque, cavity, gum inflammation, and healthy tooth. YOLOv12 and YOLOv8 models are trained on publicly available annotated dental image datasets and compared in terms of precision, recall, mean average precision (mAP), and inference speed; both models are also used together in the deployed system, with their

outputs fused into a single clinical detection set. After training, the system is tested at CodiSmile Dental Clinic to assess how it performs in an actual clinical environment. Detection results are displayed through a results interface that shows bounding boxes, condition labels, plain-language descriptions, and a computed risk classification for licensed dentists, and findings are saved in a per-patient record that can be reviewed across visits. Based on the detected findings, a recommendation feature that uses the K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) algorithm classifies the screening into a risk tier and generates a personalized prevention plan for each patient. The system also generates a downloadable PDF screening report for clinical recordkeeping and maintains an audit log of sensitive staff actions for administrative review. Toothwise is a browser-based web application; for the study it is deployed on cloud hosting (the React frontend on Vercel, the FastAPI backend on Render, and the PostgreSQL database on Neon), so clinic staff and patients can open it from any device with a modern web browser and an Internet connection. The intended users are licensed dentists and clinic personnel at CodiSmile Dental Clinic; in addition, patients may register for a self-service portal to view their own screening history and past findings. The system is evaluated by IT experts and patient respondents through an online questionnaire based on six ISO/IEC 25010 quality characteristics, and the respondents also assess its effect on screening consistency and screening time compared with the current manual process.

**Delimitations**

Toothwise is a support tool and not a replacement for a licensed dentist. The dentist at CodiSmile Dental Clinic always has the final say on any diagnosis or treatment decision. The prevention plan is meant to guide the patient and is not a formal medical prescription, so it does not include medication, treatment procedures, or dosages. The system works only with still photographs that are uploaded as image files (for example, a photograph taken with a smartphone camera); it does not analyze live video, does not process X-rays or any other radiographic input, and does not require specialized intraoral camera hardware. It is limited to the five classes named above and does not detect oral

cancer, bone loss, impacted teeth, orthodontic issues, or other conditions that surface-level visual detection cannot reliably identify. The comparison of detection models is limited to YOLOv12 and YOLOv8 and does not include other detection architectures. The system is developed and tested only at CodiSmile Dental Clinic and does not integrate with billing or appointment scheduling systems. The evaluation covers software performance, quality, and acceptability, and does not measure long-term clinical outcomes such as changes in caries rates over time.

**Limitations**

The accuracy of the detection models depends on image quality, lighting, camera positioning, and the patient's cooperation when the photograph is taken, and may vary more than it would with specialized intraoral camera hardware since a standard device camera is used instead. Because the models are trained on public datasets, performance in the clinic may differ from training results if the clinic's captured images look different from the dataset images. The quality of the KNN-generated risk classification and recommendations depends on its reference data, which starts as synthetic cases and grows as the dentist confirms tiers. Findings may not generalize to other clinics, camera devices, or patient populations.

The quality of the KNN-generated risk classification and recommendations depends on its reference data, which starts as synthetic cases and grows as the dentist confirms tiers. Findings may not generalize to other clinics, camera devices, or patient populations. Finally, the study deployment uses free hosting tiers: the backend sleeps after 15 minutes without requests, so the first request after a quiet period can take about a minute while the service starts again, and the backend has 512 MB of memory, which is why the deployed models run on ONNX Runtime and are loaded one at a time for each screening.

### 1.5 Significance of the Study

This study is expected to benefit the following groups:

**Patients.** Patients of CodiSmile Dental Clinic may benefit from a more consistent screening experience, in which findings such as tartar, plaque, cavities, gum inflammation, and healthy tooth are shown visually, explained in plain language, and accompanied by a risk classification. The personalized prevention plan gives them specific guidance based on their own findings, which can support earlier preventive action and better awareness of their oral health, and the patient portal allows them to review their own screening history at any time.

**Dentists and CodiSmile Dental Clinic.** Toothwise serves as a screening support tool that gives licensed dentists a consistent, image-based reference during consultations, while diagnosis and treatment decisions remain with them. The per-patient record of images, findings, and risk classifications gives the clinic a standardized documentation of screenings that can be reviewed and compared across visits, which the clinic currently lacks, and the PDF reporting and audit logging features support clinical recordkeeping and administrative oversight.

**IT Practitioners and Software Developers.** The comparison of YOLOv12 and YOLOv8, the use of KNN for risk classification and recommendations, and the ISO/IEC 25010 evaluation provide a documented example of building and assessing an AI-based health support system in a real clinic setting.

**Future Researchers.** Students and researchers interested in AI in dentistry can use the methodology, dataset preparation, model comparison, and system design of this study as a basis for further work, such as expanding the detectable conditions, testing other clinics, or studying long-term clinical outcomes.

**The Research Community.** There are relatively few local studies that apply AI-based detection to dental screening in the Philippine setting. This project contributes to that growing body of work and may serve as a reference for similar initiatives at other clinics across the country.

## 1.6 Definition of Terms

For clarity and common understanding, the following terms are defined based on how they are used in this study.

**Calculus (Tartar).** A hardened deposit of mineralized plaque that forms on the tooth surface and along the gumline. In this study, it refers to one of the five conditions detected by the Toothwise system.

**Dental Caries (Cavity).** The decay and structural breakdown of tooth enamel and underlying tissue caused by bacterial activity. In this study, it refers to one of the five conditions detected by the Toothwise system.

**Gum Inflammation (Gingival Inflammation).** A visible reddening, swelling, or irritation of the gum tissue, often an early indicator of gingivitis. In this study, it refers to one of the five conditions detected by the Toothwise system.

**Inference Speed.** The amount of time a trained detection model takes to process an input image and produce a detection result. In this study, it is one of the metrics used to compare the performance of YOLOv12 and YOLOv8.

**K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN).** A supervised machine learning algorithm introduced by Cover and Hart (1967), which classifies a new case by identifying and comparing it to the most similar cases in a reference dataset. In this study, KNN is used to classify each screening into a risk tier and generate a personalized prevention plan based on a patient's detected findings.

**Mean Average Precision (mAP).** A standard evaluation metric for object detection models that summarizes a model's precision and recall performance across all detected classes. In this study, it is one of the metrics used to compare YOLOv12 and YOLOv8.

**ONNX Runtime.** An open-source engine for running machine learning models saved in the Open Neural Network Exchange (ONNX) format. In this study, the deployed

system uses ONNX exports of the trained YOLOv8 and YOLOv12 models so that both can run on a small cloud server without PyTorch.

**Plaque.** A soft, sticky film of bacteria that forms on the surface of teeth. In this study, it refers to one of the five conditions detected by the Toothwise system.

**Precision.** A performance metric that measures the proportion of correctly identified detections out of all detections made by the model. In this study, it is used to evaluate and compare the performance of YOLOv12 and YOLOv8.

**Recall.** A performance metric that measures the proportion of actual conditions in an image that were correctly identified by the model. In this study, it is used to evaluate and compare the performance of YOLOv12 and YOLOv8.

**Risk Score.** A numerical value from 0 to 100, classified as low, medium, or high, generated by the system from a patient's detected findings to indicate the overall severity of a screening result. In this study, the risk score is computed by a rule-based formula.

**Toothwise.** The AI-assisted dental screening support system developed in this study, which uses YOLOv12 and YOLOv8 for detection and KNN for risk classification and generating personalized prevention plans.

**YOLOv8 (You Only Look Once, version 8).** An object detection model architecture in the YOLO family, used in this study as a baseline for comparison against YOLOv12 in detecting dental conditions.

**YOLOv12 (You Only Look Once, version 12).** An attention-centric object detection model architecture introduced by Tian et al. (2025), used in this study as the primary detection model for identifying dental conditions from intraoral images.

# CHAPTER II

# REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE AND STUDIES

This chapter presents the related literature and studies that have been gathered by the proponents. It introduces many ideas linked to the topic, which includes the research's principal focus. The study's synthesis is offered to analyze the previous research that the researchers have gathered.

## 2.1 Related Literature

**Convolutional Neural Networks for Dental Image Diagnostics.** Schwendicke et al. (2019) carried out a scoping review of 36 studies, published from 2015 to 2019, that applied convolutional neural networks (CNNs) to dental images. Most of the studies detected, segmented, or classified anatomical structures such as teeth, jaw bone, and skeletal landmarks, and only a few targeted pathologies such as caries. The authors noted that CNNs have shown the potential to detect structures and pathologies on medical images with accuracy similar to, or even higher than, that of professionals, but they also warned of possible bias in the underlying algorithms and of limited robustness and generalizability. These cautions carry directly into Toothwise, where the models are evaluated on a held-out test split and all detected findings at CodiSmile Dental Clinic are reviewed by a licensed dentist before being communicated to any patient. The review also shows that the field has concentrated on detection and segmentation tasks, which is the gap that the personalized prevention plan feature of Toothwise was built to address.

**Deep Learning for Caries Detection: A Systematic Review.** Mohammad-Rahimi et al. (2022) reviewed 42 studies that used machine learning and deep learning to detect caries across different image types, including intraoral photographs. Their main takeaway was that deep learning, particularly convolutional neural networks, worked reliably for identifying both early and more advanced carious lesions. They also raised a concern that is very relevant to this project: there are not many large, standardized, and publicly available dental datasets out there, which makes it harder to train models that

perform well across different clinical settings. For Toothwise, this limitation was addressed by combining publicly available annotated datasets with data augmentation techniques during model training. The studies they reviewed covered classification, object detection, and segmentation only, with image, object, or pixel accuracy between 68% and 99%, and the authors concluded that deep learning models can serve as an assistant for decisions on the presence or absence of carious lesions. None of the reviewed models went on to produce a recommendation, which reinforces why the prevention plan feature of Toothwise fills a genuine gap in the existing body of work.

**Deep Learning for Detecting Dental Plaque and Gingivitis from Oral Photographs.** Moharrami et al. (2025) conducted a systematic review evaluating deep learning models specifically for detecting dental plaque and gingivitis from RGB intraoral photographs, including images captured through standard consumer devices rather than specialized dental equipment. Across the studies they reviewed, models showed stronger and more consistent performance for plaque detection than for gingivitis, where the certainty of evidence was rated lower due to the more subtle and gradual visual presentation of early gingival inflammation. This finding is directly relevant to Toothwise, since gum inflammation is one of the five conditions the system is trained to detect from standard-camera photographs; it signals that this class may require more careful dataset curation and potentially larger sample sizes than the other conditions to reach comparable performance during training.

**Oral Screening of Dental Calculus, Gingivitis, and Dental Caries through Segmentation on Intraoral Photographic Images.** Liu et al. (2024) developed a deep learning segmentation system, Oral-Mamba, capable of simultaneously detecting three conditions — dental caries, dental calculus, and gingivitis — from a single set of intraoral photographic images, achieving accuracy rates above 0.81 for each condition. This study is one of the few in the literature that approaches multi-condition detection from a single intraoral image source rather than treating each condition as a separate, isolated detection task. It directly supports the feasibility of the multi-class detection approach used in

Toothwise, which similarly trains a single model to identify several distinct conditions — tartar, plaque, cavity, and gum inflammation — from one still-image source.

**Oral Health Philippines Country Profile.** The World Health Organization (2022) released a country-specific oral health profile for the Philippines as part of its Global Oral Health Status Report. The numbers are difficult to ignore. Dental caries was listed as one of the most prevalent health concerns in the country, with high rates of untreated cases across all age groups. The report also pointed out something that many Filipinos already know from experience: access to dental care is not evenly distributed. People in rural and community settings have significantly fewer options, and the limited dental workforce makes it harder to reach those who need care the most. This profile is the most authoritative reference for understanding the national oral health landscape that Toothwise seeks to contribute to. Deploying an artificial intelligence-assisted screening system at CodiSmile Dental Clinic is a concrete step toward addressing the access and consistency gaps that the WHO profile describes.

**Pediatrician Knowledge, Attitude and Practices on Children's Oral Health in a Tertiary Public Hospital in the Philippines.** Oliveros-Villarico et al. (2023) looked at the role of pediatricians in preventing dental caries among Filipino children, a role that often goes undiscussed. Their survey of 122 pediatricians at a tertiary public hospital found that most had high oral health knowledge (67.8%) and a positive attitude toward caries prevention (85.0%), but that their reported practices, such as caries risk assessment and preventive oral health education, varied. The authors describe dental caries as a tolerated and overlooked chronic disease in the Philippines, with untreated caries in the primary teeth of 85.18% of five-year-olds. For this project, this literature helps explain why a tool like Toothwise matters at the clinic level: knowledge alone has not translated into consistent early detection, and an AI-assisted screening system that flags dental conditions during a regular consultation at CodiSmile Dental Clinic can help catch problems before they get worse.

**Guiding Responsible AI in Healthcare in the Philippines.** Sarmiento et al. (2025) reviewed the barriers to the safe and effective deployment of AI in Philippine healthcare and drew on lessons from other Southeast Asian nations, the European Union, and the United States to propose directions for a national strategy. They noted that the Philippines lags behind fellow ASEAN member states in governmental AI readiness, and they pointed to structural constraints, such as connectivity, data stewardship, and workforce capacity, together with governance requirements, such as bias and safety monitoring, transparency, and accountability, that must accompany any deployment. These points shaped several decisions in how Toothwise was designed, particularly the requirement that all AI detection results at CodiSmile Dental Clinic are reviewed and confirmed by a licensed dentist before they are communicated to patients, that every sensitive action is written to an audit log, and that patient data is stored securely with authenticated access in line with the Data Privacy Act of 2012.

**An Overview of Recommendation Techniques and Their Applications in Healthcare.** Yue et al. (2021) reviewed the major recommendation approaches used in healthcare contexts, namely content-based, collaborative filtering, and hybrid methods, and mapped their application across five scenarios: dietary recommendation, lifestyle recommendation, training recommendation, decision-making support for patients and physicians, and disease-related prediction. Their review positions K-Nearest Neighbors-based approaches as a foundational technique underlying several of these healthcare recommendation scenarios, particularly where recommendations are generated by classifying a case according to its similarity to previously seen cases. This framework directly informs how the KNN-based risk classification and prevention plan feature of Toothwise was conceptualized, positioning it within the "decision-making support for patients" category identified in their review, an application area that, per their analysis, remains comparatively underexplored relative to dietary and lifestyle recommendation systems.

## 2.2 Related Studies

**Detecting White Spot Lesions on Dental Photography Using Deep Learning.** Askar et al. (2021) worked on detecting white spot lesions in intraoral dental photos captured with standard consumer cameras, using deep learning. White spot lesions are early stage demineralization, essentially the very beginning of a cavity before it becomes a visible hole. What made this study particularly useful is that it was done with a small dataset, which is a realistic constraint for many research projects, including this one. Despite that limitation, the model still managed to detect subtle surface level changes that would be easy to miss in a routine visual check. For Toothwise, this matters because it shows that even with limited annotated data and images from standard, non-specialized cameras, deep learning can pick up early, crucial changes from photographs, which is the same image modality the system uses at CodiSmile Dental Clinic. It also gave the team confidence that training a YOLOv12 model for early cavity detection is achievable even when the training dataset is not massive and specialized imaging hardware is not required.

**Ultralytics YOLO (Version 8.0.0).** Jocher et al. (2023) released YOLOv8 as an open source framework under the Ultralytics platform. Compared to older YOLO versions, YOLOv8 came with a cleaner training pipeline, an anchor free detection head, and support for multiple tasks like detection, segmentation, and classification all in one package. It became one of the most widely used detection frameworks in both academic and applied settings because it was relatively easy to work with while still delivering strong results. Understanding YOLOv8 matters for this project because YOLOv12 was built on the same foundation. The training tools, dataset formats, and evaluation methods used in YOLOv8 largely carry over to YOLOv12, so much of what Jocher et al. (2023) established applies directly to how the Toothwise models were trained and tested. YOLOv8 also serves as the direct comparison baseline against YOLOv12 in this study's model evaluation.

**Accuracy in Diagnosing Caries in Young Permanent Molars Using Interproximal Radiographic Imaging and Validation by Artificial Intelligence.** de Brito et al. (2025) compared the caries diagnoses of calibrated dentists on interproximal radiographs of the first permanent molars of children aged 6 to 9 with an AI pipeline in which YOLOv8 located the teeth and a pre-trained EfficientNet-B0 model classified each tooth as carious or sound. Agreement between the examiners was excellent (97.4%, kappa 0.88); YOLOv8 detected the carious teeth with 91% accuracy and 98% precision, and EfficientNet-B0 classified teeth with and without caries lesions with 89% accuracy. This study provides evidence that YOLOv8 is a credible baseline for caries-related detection tasks, supporting its selection as the comparison model against YOLOv12 in this study.

**Deep Learning in Oral Hygiene: Automated Dental Plaque Detection via YOLO Frameworks and Quantification Using the O'Leary Index.** Ramírez-Pedraza et al. (2025) trained and compared several YOLO model variants, including YOLOv11, specifically for detecting dental plaque in varied imaging conditions, using the O'Leary Index as a clinical benchmark for plaque quantification. Their results showed that YOLO-based models could reliably distinguish plaque at different stages of maturity, though newer, less mineralized plaque was harder to detect than older, more visually distinct plaque, since it tends to blend with surrounding gingival tissue. This finding is directly relevant to Toothwise, since it identifies a specific detection challenge, distinguishing early plaque from gum tissue, that the model must account for during training and dataset annotation for the plaque class.

**Diagnostic Accuracy of Dental Caries Detection Using Ensemble Deep Learning with Intraoral Camera Images.** Kang et al. (2024) took a different approach from most dental AI studies by using an ensemble of deep learning models rather than a single model for caries detection. By combining multiple detectors, they were able to reduce false positives while keeping sensitivity high, which is especially important in a clinical setting where unnecessary alarms can make dentists lose trust in the system. Their work confirmed that photographic intraoral images, rather than radiographs, are a

sufficient and practical input for reliable AI-based detection, validated against annotations made by an experienced dentist. This finding supports the still-image, standard-camera approach used in Toothwise, and gave the team confidence that deep learning for photographic dental screening is not just theoretically possible but has already been shown to work efficiently in a clinical environment similar to CodiSmile Dental Clinic.

**AI-Assisted Detection of Interproximal, Occlusal, and Secondary Caries on Bite-Wing Radiographs: A Single-Shot Deep Learning Approach.** Karakuş et al. (2024) applied YOLOv8 to the task of detecting different types of dental caries from bitewing radiographs. One thing that stood out in their findings was how well YOLOv8 handled small and overlapping lesions, which is a tricky problem in dental imaging because caries can be close together or partially hidden. Even though Toothwise uses standard photographic images rather than radiographs, the core detection challenge is similar. The model needs to find and correctly label multiple small, carious areas within a single image. The performance of YOLOv8 in this study, combined with the architectural improvements introduced in YOLOv12, provided the team with a strong technical basis for believing that YOLOv12 can handle the multi-condition detection demands of Toothwise.

**YOLOv12: Attention-Centric Real-Time Object Detectors.** Tian et al. (2025) introduced YOLOv12 in a preprint that gained significant attention in the computer vision community. The paper presents a new approach to the YOLO architecture centered around area attention mechanisms, which allow the model to focus on relevant regions of an image rather than processing everything equally. The results were impressive. The YOLOv12 N configuration achieved 40.6% mean average precision at an inference latency of just 1.64 milliseconds on a T4 GPU, outperforming comparable YOLOv10 and YOLOv11 models. For a system like Toothwise, where detection results need to be produced quickly enough to fit within a standard dental consultation, that combination of accuracy and speed is exactly what is needed. This paper is the primary technical reference for the detection model used in this project, and its findings directly justify

choosing YOLOv12 for evaluation against YOLOv8 for deployment at CodiSmile Dental Clinic. At the time of this review, no widely published study had applied YOLOv12 specifically to multi-condition dental screening from standard photographic images, positioning Toothwise among the earliest efforts to explore this architecture in that context.

**Feedback Collection and Nearest-Neighbor Profiling for Recommendation Systems in Healthcare Scenarios.** António et al. (2024) developed a physical activity recommendation system for patients in rehabilitation using a K-Nearest Neighbors sampling strategy combined with feedback collection, generating activity recommendations by identifying patients with the highest similarity to a given case based on their health profile. Their system was shown to outperform traditional collaborative filtering and purely human-constrained recommendation methods in producing recommendations suited to a patient's specific therapeutic needs, physical capacity, and stage of recovery. This is one of the few studies to apply a KNN-based approach directly to generating personalized, condition-specific health guidance rather than general product or content recommendations, and it provides a close technical parallel for how Toothwise's KNN-based feature classifies a screening into a risk tier and composes a prevention plan by matching a patient's findings against similar synthetic and dentist-confirmed cases.

**Bridging the Gap or Widening the Divide: A Call for Capacity-Building in Artificial Intelligence for Healthcare in the Philippines.** Gutierrez and Viacrusis (2023) took a critical look at AI readiness in Philippine healthcare. When they asked GPT-4, GPT-3, Bard, and Claude about isoniazid dosing for Filipinos compared with other ethnic groups, three of the four models produced convincing but false content. The authors argued that regions with lower medical research output risk bias and misrepresentation in AI-generated content, and they called on Filipino clinicians and researchers to begin capacity-building, including locally representative data, quality assurance, and early AI education in medical schools, before relying on such tools in clinical practice. This study

speaks directly to a design decision in Toothwise. The system does not allow AI detection results to be shown to patients without going through a dentist first. At CodiSmile Dental Clinic, the dentist reviews every output before it becomes part of the clinical record or is communicated to the patient, which reflects the caution that Gutierrez and Viacrusis called for.

**2.3 Synthesis**

The literature and studies reviewed in this chapter come together to build a clear and well-supported case for the approach that Toothwise has taken. Schwendicke et al. (2019) and Mohammad-Rahimi et al. (2022) showed through separate reviews that deep learning models are genuinely reliable for dental caries detection, often performing at the level of trained clinicians or better. Moharrami et al. (2025) and Liu et al. (2024) extended this evidence beyond caries alone, showing that plaque, calculus, and gingivitis can also be reliably detected from standard intraoral photographs, with the work of Liu et al. in particular demonstrating that multiple conditions can be detected from a single image source using one model, directly supporting the five-class detection approach used in Toothwise. Kang et al. (2024) and Askar et al. (2021) further confirmed that photographic images captured without specialized intraoral camera hardware are a sufficient and practical input modality for AI-based detection in an actual clinical setting, closely paralleling the still-image, standard-camera acquisition approach of Toothwise at CodiSmile Dental Clinic.

The most important gap identified across the reviewed works is that existing dental AI systems detect conditions but stop there; the photograph-based reviews by Moharrami et al. (2024, 2025) cover detection only. None of the detection-focused studies reviewed generated recommendations or patient-facing guidance after detection. At the same time, Yue et al. (2021) and António et al. (2024) show that KNN-based recommendation approaches have been successfully applied in other healthcare domains, such as physical rehabilitation, but remain comparatively unexplored in dental screening

specifically. Toothwise fills this gap by embedding a KNN-based risk classification and recommendation engine into a multi-condition detection pipeline, pairing YOLO-based detection with an actionable, personalized prevention plan, a combination not found together in the literature reviewed.

On the technical side, Tian et al. (2025) established YOLOv12 as a highly accurate and efficient real-time object detection architecture, while Jocher et al. (2023), de Brito et al. (2025), Ramírez-Pedraza et al. (2025), and Karakuş et al. (2024) documented the strong and well-validated performance of YOLOv8 specifically across caries and plaque detection tasks, supporting its selection as this study's comparison baseline. Askar et al. (2021) further showed that deep learning-based detection is achievable even under limited dataset conditions, supporting the training strategy used in this project.

The Philippine context literature from the WHO (2022) and Oliveros-Villarico et al. (2023) grounds all of this in a concrete public health reality. Dental conditions are widespread among Filipinos, they often go undetected until they have already progressed, and access to professional dental care remains out of reach for many due to cost and geography. Sarmiento et al. (2025) and Gutierrez and Viacrusis (2023) shaped responsible design decisions around human oversight, data privacy, and clinical transparency. What no existing work reviewed has done is bring together YOLO-based multi-condition detection from standard photographic images, a KNN-based risk classification and personalized prevention plan generator, and a full-stack clinical system deployed at an actual Philippine dental clinic. That is the specific contribution of Toothwise.

# CHAPTER III
# METHODOLOGY

This chapter presents the methodology used in the development of Toothwise: A YOLO-Based Multi-Condition Dental Screening System with KNN-Based Recommendation for CodiSmile Dental Clinic. It describes the development methodology, the composition and responsibilities of the five-member development team, the project planning and requirements analysis process, the major system design diagrams required for the capstone examination, and the development, testing, and screenshot documentation of the current system.

## 3.1 Development Methodology

Toothwise was developed using the Agile Software Development Life Cycle (Agile SDLC). Agile was selected because the system integrates several interconnected components, including a React.js web interface, a FastAPI REST backend, a PostgreSQL database, a dual-model YOLOv8/YOLOv12 detection pipeline, a KNN-based risk classification and recommendation engine, authentication and authorization, audit logging, a separate patient self-service portal, and a cloud deployment of all three tiers. These components benefit from incremental development, continuous testing, regular review, and repeated refinement rather than a single sequential build.

Instead of completing the entire system in one long development cycle, the project was carried out through manageable iterations in which requirements were prioritized, features were implemented, tested, reviewed, and improved before the next set of features was developed. Each iteration followed the same general cycle of planning, requirements analysis, system design, development, testing, evaluation, and refinement, illustrated in Figure 1.

The cycle in Figure 1 was applied repeatedly across the project's documented iterations. Planning and requirements analysis identified the features required for the

clinic workflow; system design translated those requirements into frontend routes, API endpoints, and database structures; development implemented the corresponding React, FastAPI, and machine-learning components; testing verified the implemented behavior; evaluation compared the result against the intended requirements; and refinement corrected any issues found before the next iteration began.

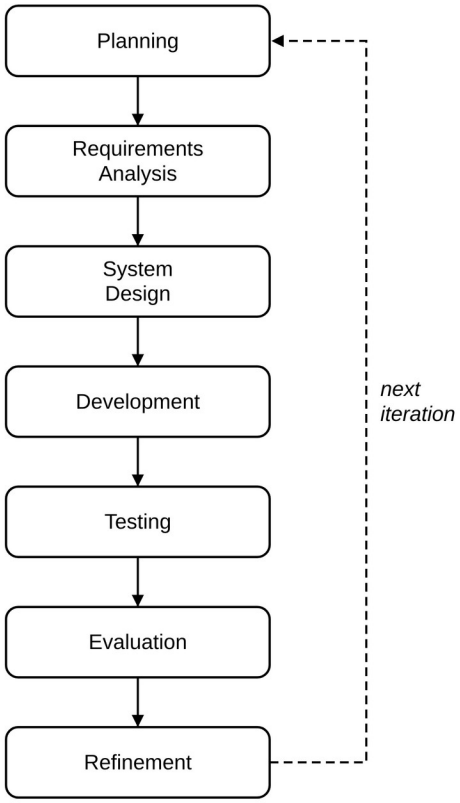



**Figure 1 Agile Development Methodology.**

### 3.2 Project Planning

The Toothwise project was planned around the screening and record-keeping workflow of CodiSmile Dental Clinic. The following considerations guided the planning of the system:

- **Project Objectives** — to provide CodiSmile Dental Clinic with an AI-assisted dental screening system that detects tartar, plaque, cavity, gum inflammation, and healthy tooth from a still photograph, estimates a risk level, and generates a

recommendation/prevention plan, while also supporting day-to-day clinic record-keeping.

- **Project Scope** — the system covers staff authentication, patient management, dental screening and AI detection from uploaded still images, risk assessment, recommendation generation, password recovery, clinical notes, PDF reporting, audit logging, a self-service patient portal, a public AI assistant, and cloud deployment.
- **Target Users** — CodiSmile Dental Clinic staff (dentist, receptionist, and assistant roles) and the clinic's patients through the patient portal.
- **Clinic Workflow** — a patient is registered or already on file, a still intraoral photograph taken with a standard device camera is uploaded during a screening, the system produces detection, risk, and recommendation results for the dentist to review, and the dentist may confirm the risk tier, add clinical notes, or generate a PDF report.
- **Functional Requirements** — detailed in Section 3.4.
- **Non-Functional Requirements** — detailed in Section 3.4, covering security, privacy, usability, reliability, performance efficiency, and data protection.
- **AI Screening Requirements** — the system was planned to use two independent detection models (YOLOv8 and YOLOv12) whose outputs are fused into a single clinical detection set, rather than relying on a single model.
- **Database Requirements** — a relational PostgreSQL schema was planned to store staff accounts, patients, screenings and their photographs, detections, recommendations, clinical notes, and audit logs with referential integrity between related records.
- **Security Requirements** — JWT-based authentication, hashed passwords, rate-limited login endpoints, secure password recovery, authenticated (non-public)

image access, and audit logging were planned from the outset given the clinical and personal nature of the data involved.

- **Deployment Requirements** — the system had to run on free cloud hosting without a payment card, which limits the backend to 512 MB of memory and a disk that is cleared whenever the service restarts.

The requirements and technical decisions behind this planning were drawn directly from the current Toothwise project package rather than from separate interview transcripts or survey forms, since the project does not maintain those as separate dated records. Table 1 summarizes the actual sources used.

**Table 1 Sources of Requirements and Technical Data**

| Source | Use in the Study |
|---|---|
| System and code review | The frontend routes, pages, API client, FastAPI routers, schemas, security module, ML modules, and database models were reviewed to identify actual implemented functions and data flows. |
| Database and schema review | The PostgreSQL schema, SQLAlchemy models, and migration scripts were reviewed to verify entities, relationships, enumerated values, detection sets, stored screening photos, and audit logs. |
| Testing and debugging records | The automated backend test suite (119 test cases) and the project's version history document API contract reconciliation, enum and image-path fixes, smoke testing, security validation, and feature verification. |
| AI evaluation procedure | The evaluate_models.py utility defines how precision, recall, F1, mAP50, mAP50-95, and average inference time are obtained from a labeled test set. The trained YOLOv8 and YOLOv12 weights are installed, and the measured results are reported in Chapter IV. |
| Deployment configuration | The Render blueprint (render.yaml), the Vercel configuration, the backend Dockerfile, and the deployment guide (docs/DEPLOYMENT.md) were reviewed to document the hosting environment and its limits. |

### 3.3 Roles and Responsibilities of the Five-Member Development Team

Toothwise was developed by a five-member capstone development team. Table 2 presents each member's assigned role and corresponding responsibilities based on the

work represented in the current project package. A member may carry more than one responsibility.

**Table 2 Roles and Responsibilities of the Development Team**

| Group Member | Assigned Role | Responsibilities |
|---|---|---|
| Arreola, Reizen S. | Project Manager / System Analyst / Programmer | Coordinated the activities of the development team, monitored the project schedule, translated clinic workflow requirements into system requirements, and ensured that project deliverables remained aligned with the objectives of the Toothwise system; developed and integrated the YOLOv8/YOLOv12 dental image detection pipeline and the KNN recommendation engine. |
| Magpantay, Rizelle Carla N. | Backend Developer | Implemented and integrated the FastAPI REST API, authentication and authorization logic, and database operations and connected the frontend with the backend API; resolved programming and integration issues identified during testing. |
| Sales, Keith Ashly V. | Frontend Developer | Implemented the React.js user interface, including the dashboard, patient and dentist management screens, screening workflow, patient portal, and the visual design and layout of the system. |
| Tubillas, Brayan Axel L. | Database Developer / Documentation Lead | Designed and maintained the PostgreSQL database schema and relationships; and conducted functional, security, and integration testing of the system; responsible for organizing, compiling, and standardizing all documents into a cohesive capstone paper that complies with formatting, style, and academic guidelines. |
| Ponce, Robin C. | UI-UX Designer | Responsible for defining information architecture, and creating accessible design system for Toothwise, to ensure the capstone deliverable delivers an intuitive, user-centered experience. |

The specific division of responsibilities above reflects the major components of the current system — project coordination and requirements, backend/API development, frontend/interface development, database/documentation, and interface design work.

### 3.4 Requirements Analysis

The requirements of Toothwise were analyzed from the intended clinic workflow and the functions represented in the current system and its API. Toothwise has two authenticated user groups: clinic staff (dentist, receptionist, and assistant roles) and patients using the self-service portal. Tables 3 and 4 present the functional and non-functional requirements that are currently implemented in the application.

**Table 3 Functional Requirements**

| ID | Requirement | Specification |
|---|---|---|
| FR-01 | Staff authentication | Authenticate staff (dentist, receptionist, assistant) by email and password and issue a JWT bearer token for API access; an optional “Remember me” keeps the device signed in for 30 days. |
| FR-02 | Role-based access | Distinguish dentist, receptionist, assistant, and patient scopes and restrict functions. |
| FR-03 | Patient management | Create, view, update, and delete patient records and view screening history and risk trends. |
| FR-04 | Dental screening | Upload a still intraoral photograph (JPEG, PNG, or WebP, up to 15 MB) taken with a standard device camera in a single multipart screening request and receive detection, risk, recommendation, and screening-record results. |
| FR-05 | AI detection | Run the configured YOLOv8 and YOLOv12 detectors, retain raw model outputs, and produce a fused clinical detection set. |
| FR-06 | Risk assessment | Calculate a 0–100 risk score with a rule-based formula and classify the screening as LOW, MEDIUM, or HIGH. |
| FR-07 | Recommendation generation | Use the KNN recommender and condition-specific rules to generate an ordered prevention plan. |
| FR-08 | Screening review | View screening images, fused detections, risk information, recommendations, clinical notes, and model-comparison information; let the dentist confirm or correct the risk tier. |

| ID | Requirement | Specification |
|---|---|---|
| FR-09 | PDF report | Generate an authenticated PDF screening report containing patient/screening information, findings, prevention plan, and clinical notes. |
| FR-10 | Patient portal | Patients register, log in (with optional “Remember me”), and view their latest results, a risk-over-time chart, their next check-up date, their screening history, and screening details. |
| FR-11 | Audit logging | Record relevant authentication and create/update/delete actions for administrative review. |
| FR-12 | Health monitoring | Expose a health endpoint that checks database connectivity without exposing internal errors. |
| FR-13 | Database backup | Provide a pg_dump-based backup utility that creates timestamped, retained backups. |
| FR-14 | Photo persistence | Keep a database copy of every screening photograph and restore the file automatically when the host's disk has been cleared. |
| FR-15 | AI assistant | Answer general dental-care and clinic questions on the public website and patient portal without reading patient records. |
| FR-16 | Password recovery and change | Staff and patients who forget their password can set a new one after confirming details already on their account (staff: email and PRC license number; patients: email, birthdate, and mobile number), and signed-in users can change their password. |

**Table 4 Non-Functional Requirements**

| ID | Quality Area | Specification |
|---|---|---|
| NFR-01 | Security | Passwords hashed with bcrypt; protected operations require JWT authentication; login, registration, and password-reset endpoints rate-limited to 5 requests per minute per IP; a failed password reset always returns the same message, so it cannot reveal which accounts exist or which detail was wrong, and every reset attempt is written to the audit log. |
| NFR-02 | Privacy | Screening images are not publicly exposed; authenticated and ownership-checked image endpoints are used instead of a public upload route. |
| NFR-03 | Usability | Browser-based workflows for dashboard monitoring, patient records, screening, dentist management, audit review, and patient self-service. |

| ID | Quality Area | Specification |
|---|---|---|
| NFR-04 | Reliability | Backend returns a generic response for unhandled errors while recording diagnostic detail server-side; screening photos survive host restarts through their database copies. |
| NFR-05 | Performance Efficiency | YOLOv8 and YOLOv12 inference times are recorded per screening; model-comparison views report runtime and detection statistics; the deployed backend runs both models through ONNX Runtime within 512 MB of memory. |
| NFR-06 | Data Protection | Relational constraints, enumerated status/risk values, foreign keys, and transactions preserve consistent, valid records. |

### 3.5 System Design

This section presents the major design diagrams required for the capstone preliminary examination: the Use Case Diagram, the Entity Relationship Diagram, the Data Flow Diagrams at Level 0 and Level 1, and the development Gantt Chart. Each diagram was produced from the actual implemented system roles, database schema, and documented development sequence.

#### 3.5.1 Use Case Diagram

Figure 2 presents the use case diagram of Toothwise. It shows the four system roles – Dentist (Administrator), Receptionist, Dental Assistant, and Patient – and the functions each role can perform, verified against the implemented routes and authorization checks. A screening always includes uploading an intraoral image, and the dentist may extend the review of findings by confirming the risk tier, adding a clinical note, or generating a PDF report. Any signed-in user may also reset a forgotten password or change it, which extends Authenticate User. The diagram represents system user roles, not the development team in Section 3.3.

#### 3.5.2 Entity Relationship Diagram (ERD)

Figure 3 presents the Entity Relationship Diagram of the Toothwise PostgreSQL database, verified against the current database/schema.sql and backend/app/models.py.

The database contains eight tables: dentists, patients, screenings, screening_images, detections, recommendations, clinical_notes, and audit_logs, related through foreign keys as shown below. The screening_images table was added for the cloud deployment: it keeps a copy of each screening photograph in the database, because the hosting service clears its local disk whenever it restarts. Every field of each table is listed in the diagram.

Table 5 consolidates the eight entities of the Toothwise database into a single database schema, summarizing each table's primary key, purpose, classification, and relationships to the other entities.

**Table 5 Toothwise Database Schema Data Dictionary**

| Table | Primary Key | Role/ Classification | Purpose | Related Tables |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| dentists | id | Dimension Table | Stores staff accounts (dentist, receptionist, or assistant) used for login and access control. | screenings, clinical_notes, audit_logs |
| patients | id | Dimension Table | Stores patient demographic information and, optionally, patient-portal login credentials. | screenings |
| screenings | id | Fact Table | Central record of one AI-assisted dental image screening event, including risk level and model timing. | patients, dentists, detections, recommendations, clinical_notes, screening_images |
| screening_images | screening_id | Fact Detail Table | Database copy of a screening photograph, used to restore the image file after the host's disk is cleared. | screenings |
| detections | id | Fact Detail Table | Stores each bounding-box finding produced by the YOLOv8/YOLOv12 ensemble for a screening (5-label taxonomy). | screenings |
| recommendations | id | Fact Detail Table | Stores the risk classification and prevention/advice text generated by the KNN recommender for a | screenings |

| Table | Primary Key | Role/ Classification | Purpose | Related Tables |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | screening. | |
| clinical_notes | id | Fact Detail Table | Stores dentist-authored clinical notes attached to a screening. | screenings, dentists |
| audit_logs | id | System Table | Append-only record of sensitive staff actions, kept for administrative review. | dentists |

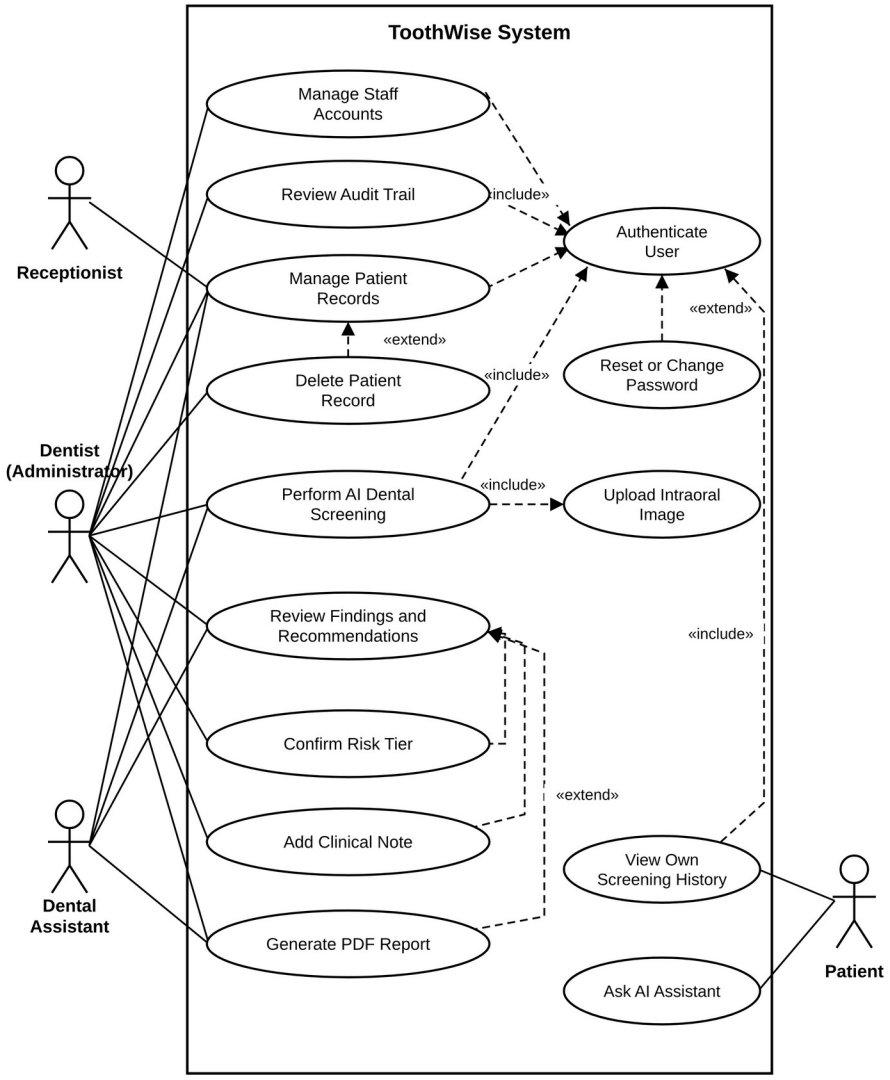



**Figure 2 Use Case Diagram.**

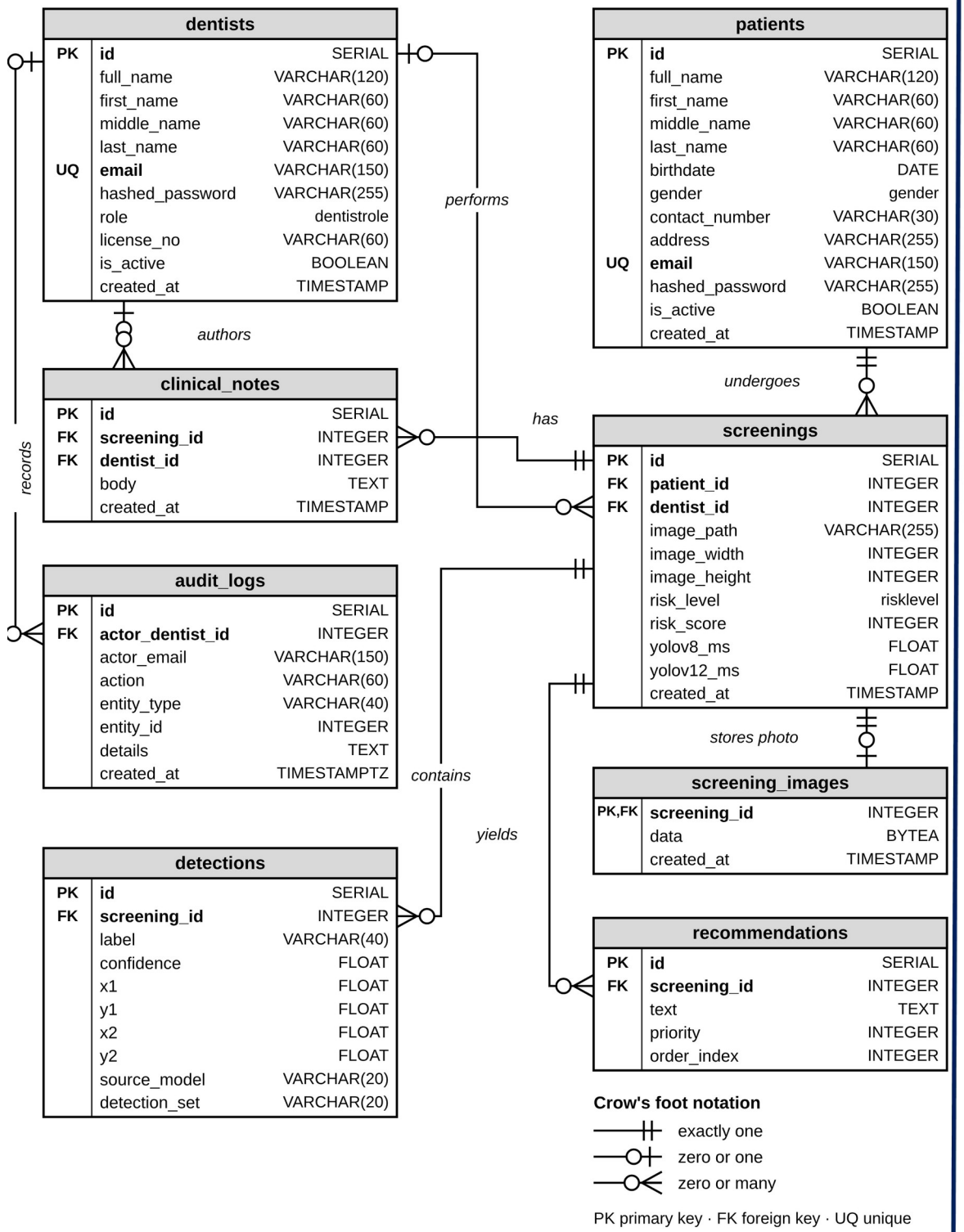



**Figure 3 Entity Relationship Diagram (ERD).**

### 3.5.3 Data Flow Diagram Level 0

Figure 4 presents the Level 0 (context) Data Flow Diagram of Toothwise, drawn in Gane and Sarson notation. It shows the system as a single process exchanging data with its four external entities – Dentist (Administrator), Receptionist, Dental Assistant, and Patient – verified against the authenticated routes each role can reach.

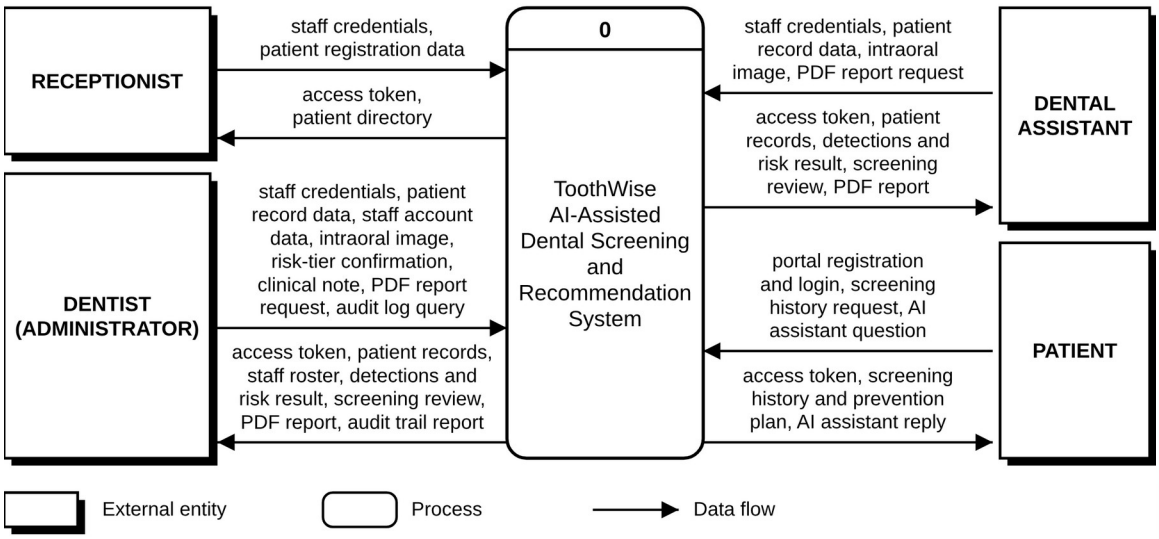



**Figure 4 Data Flow Diagram Level 0.**

### 3.5.4 Data Flow Diagram Level 1

Figure 5 decomposes the Toothwise system, in Gane and Sarson notation, into seven major processes: 1.0 Authenticate Users, 2.0 Manage Patient Records, 3.0 Manage Staff Accounts, 4.0 Perform AI Dental Screening (YOLOv8/YOLOv12 detection, risk scoring, and KNN recommendation), 5.0 Review Findings and Generate Report, 6.0 Serve Patient Portal and AI Assistant, and 7.0 Review Audit Trail. So that it remains legible in print, the diagram is drawn on two sheets: Sheet 1 covers processes 1.0, 2.0, 3.0, and 7.0, and Sheet 2 covers processes 4.0, 5.0, and 6.0. Each process is drawn in its own band with its external entities on the left and its data stores on the right, so no data flows cross. The seven data stores, D1 to D7, correspond to the database tables in Figure 3 (D3 Screenings

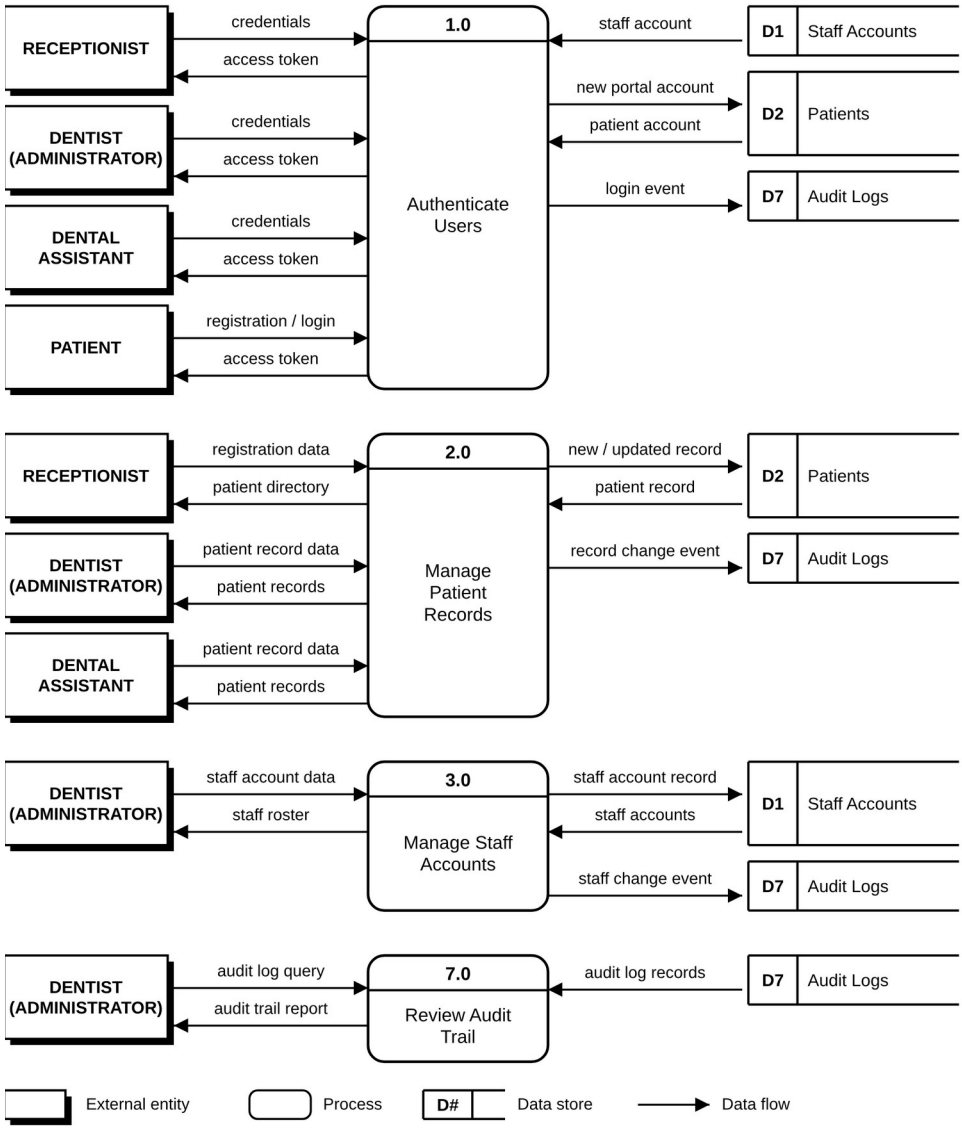
covers both the screenings and screening_images tables), and the external data flows match the Level 0 diagram in Figure 4.

Table 6 describes each Level 1 process, with its main inputs and outputs and the data stores it reads or writes.

**Table 6 Level 1 Process Descriptions**

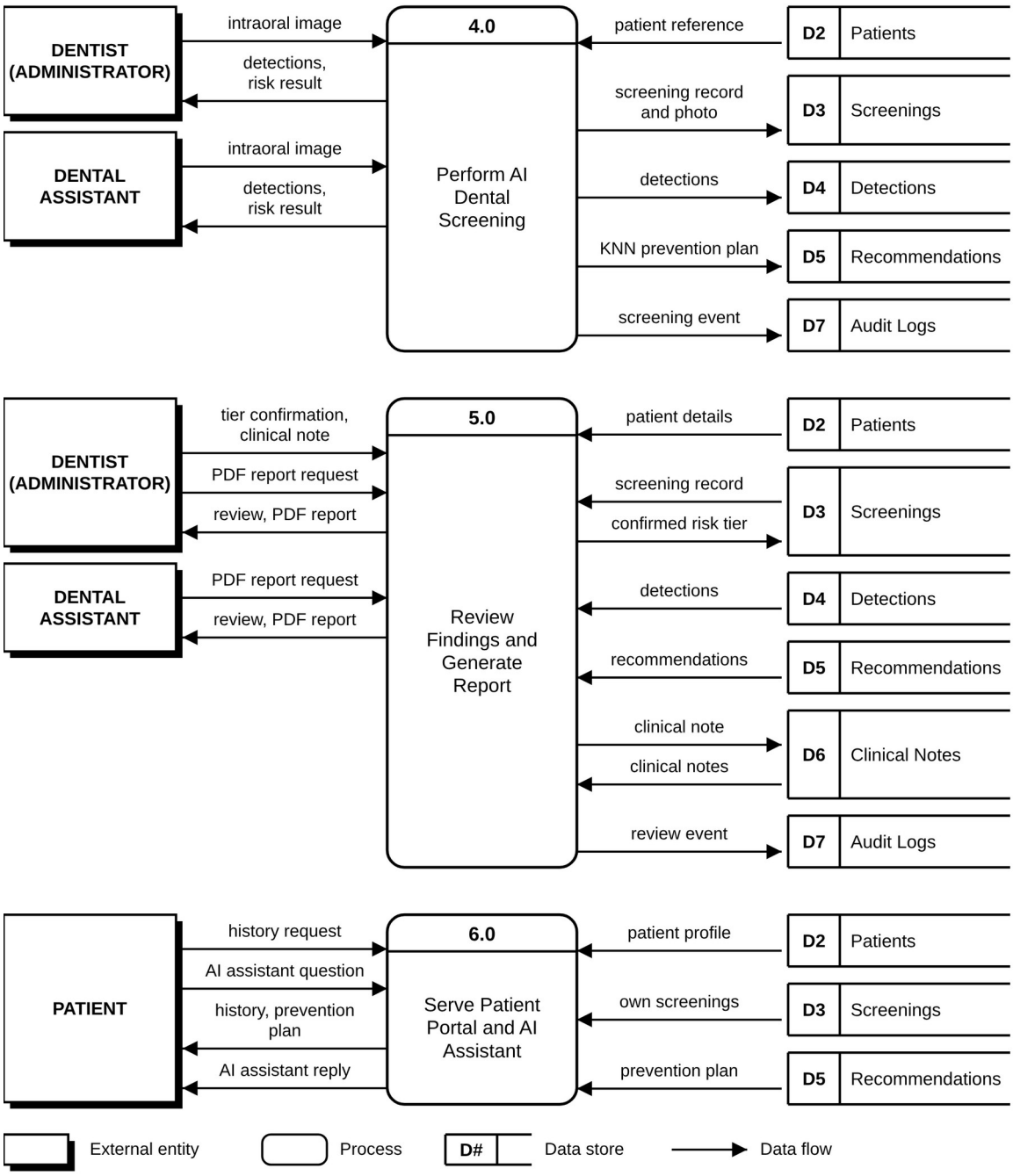
| Process | Description | Main inputs | Main outputs and data stores |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1.0 Authenticate Users | Checks staff and patient credentials and issues a JWT access token for the matching scope (30 days with “Remember me”); registers new patient-portal accounts; resets a forgotten password after checking the details on file, and changes passwords. | Credentials; portal registration; reset and change-password requests | Access token; reads D1 and D2, writes new portal accounts and new passwords to D1 and D2 and login and reset events to D7 |
| 2.0 Manage Patient Records | Creates, lists, and updates patient records; only the dentist can delete one. | Patient registration and record data | Patient directory and records; D2; record change events to D7 |
| 3.0 Manage Staff Accounts | Lets the dentist add, edit, reset, deactivate, and delete staff accounts and assign the dentist, receptionist, or assistant role. | Staff account data | Staff roster; D1; staff change events to D7 |
| 4.0 Perform AI Dental Screening | Validates the uploaded photograph, runs YOLOv8 and YOLOv12, fuses their detections, computes the risk score and tier, and builds the KNN prevention plan. | Intraoral image; patient reference from D2 | Detections and risk result; writes D3, D4, and D5; screening event to D7 |
| 5.0 Review Findings and Generate Report | Shows the screening for review, records the dentist's tier confirmation and clinical notes, and produces the PDF report. | Tier confirmation, clinical note, report request; D2 to D6 | Screening review and PDF report; confirmed tier to D3; notes to D6; review event to D7 |
| 6.0 Serve Patient Portal and AI Assistant | Shows patients only their own screenings, latest results, risk trend, and prevention plans and | History request, assistant question; D2, D3, | Screening history, prevention plan, assistant reply |

| Process | Description | Main inputs | Main outputs and data stores |
|---|---|---|---|
| | answers general questions through the AI assistant. | D5 | |
| 7.0 Review Audit Trail | Lets the dentist search and filter the audit log. | Audit log query; D7 | Audit trail report |




*Entities and data stores are repeated next to each process so that no data flows cross.*

**Figure 5 Data Flow Diagram Level 1 (Sheet 1 of 2: Processes 1.0, 2.0, 3.0, and 7.0).**




*Entities and data stores are repeated next to each process so that no data flows cross.*

**Figure 6 Data Flow Diagram Level 1 (Sheet 2 of 2: Processes 4.0, 5.0, and 6.0).**

### 3.5.5 Gantt Chart

Figure 7 presents the Toothwise development schedule from July 12 to October 30, organized into the five Agile iterations summarized in Table 12. Each bar shows the working period of one task, the black band shows the span of each iteration, and the diamonds mark the 30%, 60%, and 100% system completion milestones that the documentation followed. The final iteration includes the cloud deployment of the system and the move of the deployed models to ONNX Runtime.

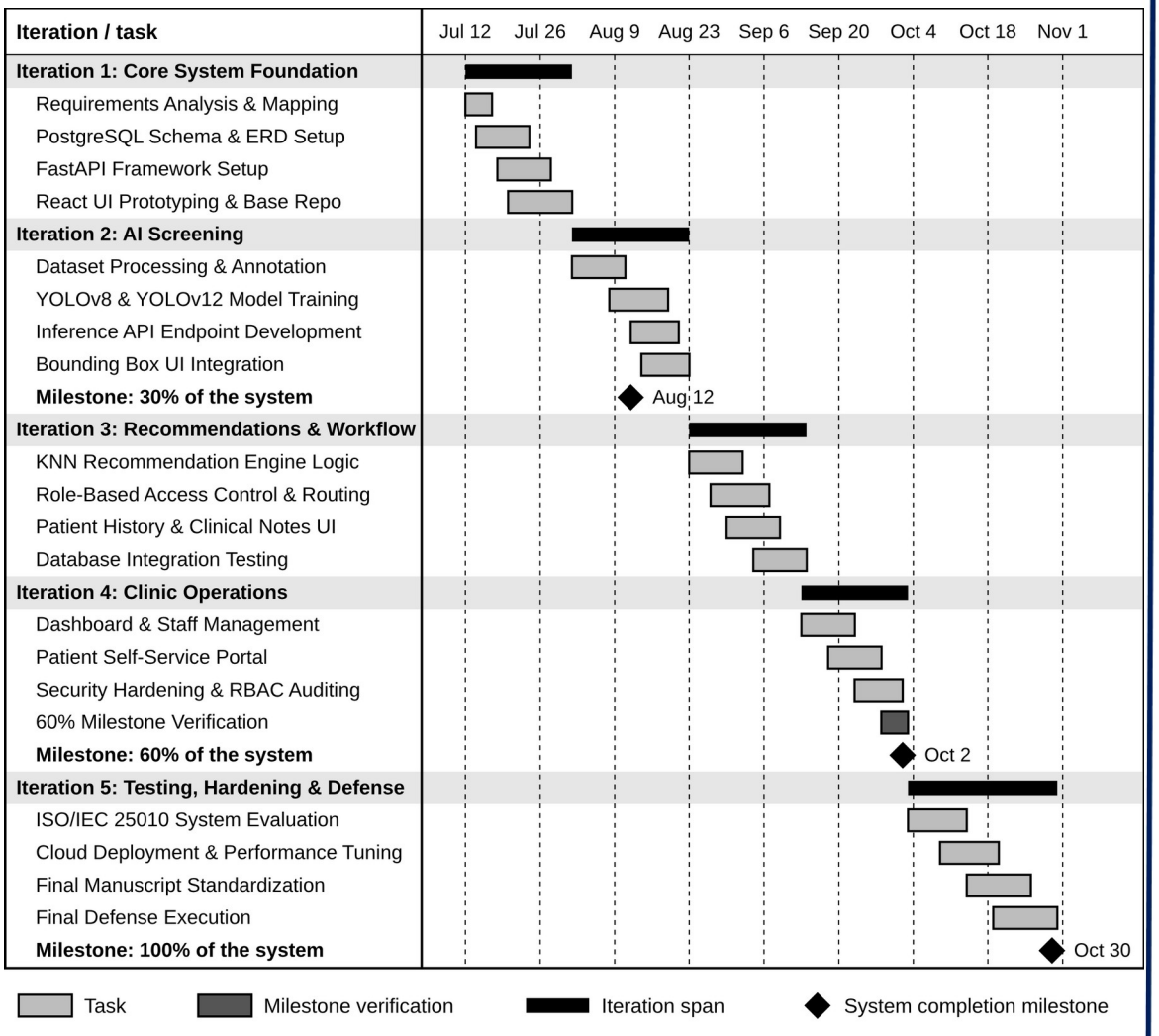



**Figure 7 Toothwise Development Gantt Chart.**

### 3.6 Software Specifications

The software requirements of Toothwise cover the programming languages, frameworks, libraries, services, and development tools represented in the current project package, distinguishing development-environment resources (Table 7) from implementation/deployment-environment resources (Table 8).

**Table 7 Software Development Requirements**

| Software | Specification | Description |
|---|---|---|
| Operating System | Windows 10 or 11, 64-bit | Primary development environment for the frontend, backend, database administration, and system testing. |
| Runtime / Backend Language | Python 3.11 | Used for the FastAPI backend, AI inference, KNN-based recommendation engine, database integration, testing, and utility scripts. |
| Frontend Language | JavaScript (ES6+) | Used to implement the React.js user interface and client-side application logic. |
| Frontend Framework | React 18.2.0 (Create React App, react-scripts 5.0.1) | Provides the component-based web interface for dentists, administrators, clinic staff, and the patient portal. |
| Routing | React Router DOM 6.21.1 | Provides client-side routing for login, dashboard, patient records, screening, staff management, audit logs, and the patient portal. |
| HTTP Client | Axios 1.6.5 | Handles authenticated communication between the React frontend and the FastAPI REST API. |
| UI Feedback and Icons | React Hot Toast 2.4.1, Lucide React 0.383.0 | Provide success and error notifications and the interface icons. |
| Image Upload | Browser file input (drag and drop) | Accepts JPEG, PNG, or WebP photographs up to 15 MB; on phones and tablets the same control can open the device camera. |
| Charting | Recharts 2.10.3 | Renders the patient risk trend and dashboard trend visualizations. |

| Software | Specification | Description |
|---|---|---|
| Backend Framework | FastAPI 0.111.0, Uvicorn 0.30.1 | Implements the REST API, request validation, authentication dependencies, routing, health checks, and integration with AI and PostgreSQL. |
| ORM / Database Driver | SQLAlchemy 2.0.30 and psycopg 3.1.19 | Provide ORM-based database access and PostgreSQL connectivity. |
| Validation / Configuration | Pydantic 2.7.4 and pydantic-settings 2.3.4 | Validate API payloads and load environment-based configuration. |
| AI Framework (training) | Ultralytics 8.4.116 with PyTorch | Trains and runs the YOLOv8 and YOLOv12 object-detection models during development. |
| AI Runtime (deployment) | ONNX Runtime 1.31.0 | Runs the ONNX exports of both models in production, without PyTorch. |
| Computer Vision | OpenCV 4.10.0.84 (headless), Pillow 10.3.0, NumPy 1.26.4 | Support image processing, validation, letterboxing, and preparation of uploaded still images. |
| Recommendation / ML | scikit-learn 1.5.0, joblib 1.4.2 | Support the KNN risk classification and recommendation model and persistence of the trained recommender artifact. |
| Database | PostgreSQL 15 | Stores patient, staff, screening, photo, detection, recommendation, clinical note, and audit-log records. |
| Authentication / Security | python-jose 3.3.0, bcrypt 4.2.0, SlowAPI 0.1.9 | Provide JWT authentication, password hashing, password reset tokens, and rate limiting. |
| PDF Reporting | ReportLab 4.2.2 | Generates authenticated PDF screening reports. |
| AI Assistant | Google Gemini API (gemini-3.6-flash) | Answers general dental-care and clinic questions for the public AI assistant. |
| Testing | pytest 8.2.2, HTTPX 0.27.0 | Support automated and API-level testing of the FastAPI application. |
| Version Control | Git and GitHub | Used for source-code versioning, collaboration, and project traceability; pushes to the main branch redeploy the hosted system. |
| IDE | Visual Studio Code | Primary editor for frontend, backend, database, and AI development. |

| Software | Specification | Description |
|---|---|---|
| Package Managers | npm and pip | Manage JavaScript and Python project dependencies. |

**Table 8 Implementation Software Requirements**

| Software | Specification | Description |
|---|---|---|
| Frontend Hosting | Vercel (Hobby plan) | Serves the React production build over HTTPS and runs the /api/chatbot serverless function for the AI assistant. |
| Backend Hosting | Render free web service, Python 3.11.9, Singapore region | Runs the FastAPI backend with Uvicorn; it is rebuilt automatically after every push and checked through /api/health. |
| Database Hosting | Neon serverless PostgreSQL (AWS Asia Pacific, Singapore) | Stores persistent clinical and administrative records, including the database copies of screening photos. |
| Client Platform | Any operating system with a modern web browser | Dentists, clinic staff, and patients access the system without installing a separate application. |
| Browser | Google Chrome 110+ or Mozilla Firefox 110+ | Supported browser environment for the React.js interface. |
| Authentication | JWT Bearer tokens | Separates staff and patient access scopes and protects authenticated API routes. |
| AI Runtime | YOLOv8 + YOLOv12 ensemble on ONNX Runtime (CPU) | Runs both detection models and fuses their outputs. Each model is loaded only while it runs so the service fits in 512 MB; its boxes, labels, and confidences are identical to the PyTorch checkpoints (checked on 22 test images). |
| Recommendation Runtime | KNN, K = 5 | Classifies the screening into a risk tier used to compose the prevention plan. |
| Upload Limit | 15 MB; JPEG, PNG, or WebP | Limits the size and type of uploaded screening images before processing. |
| Photo Storage | Local upload folder plus database copy (STORE_IMAGES_IN_DB) | Keeps screening photos available after the free host restarts and clears its disk. |
| Alternative Deployment | Docker image | For hosts with at least about 1.5 GB of |

| Software | Specification | Description |
|---|---|---|
| | (backend/Dockerfile) with PyTorch | memory, such as a Hugging Face Docker Space or a paid Render plan. |
| API Documentation | FastAPI Swagger UI / ReDoc | Provides developer-facing documentation for the REST API. |

### 3.7 Hardware Specifications

**Table 9 Hardware Development Requirements**

| Hardware | Specification | Description |
|---|---|---|
| Processor | Intel Core i7 or AMD Ryzen 7, 8 cores, 2.5 GHz or above | Recommended for concurrent frontend, backend, image-processing, and model-development workloads. |
| RAM | 16 GB minimum; 32 GB recommended | Supports model training, dataset preprocessing, database services, and development tools. |
| GPU | NVIDIA GPU with CUDA support, at least 6 GB VRAM | Recommended for practical YOLO training and accelerated inference during model development (the final models were trained on a Google Colab NVIDIA Tesla T4). |
| Storage | 512 GB SSD or higher | Stores source code, datasets, model weights, Python environments, PostgreSQL data, and generated artifacts. |
| Display | 1920 × 1080 or higher | Supports development, image review, detection overlays, and responsive interface testing. |
| Network | Stable Internet connection, 10 Mbps or higher | Supports dependency installation, dataset access, repository synchronization, and cloud deployment. |

**Table 10 Implementation Hardware Requirements**

| Hardware | Specification | Description |
|---|---|---|
| Server | Cloud web service (Render free tier): shared CPU, 512 MB RAM | Runs the FastAPI API and the YOLO and KNN inference; |

| Hardware | Specification | Description |
|---|---|---|
| | | measured at about 210 MB of memory at rest and 400 MB at peak during a screening. |
| Client Workstation | Computer, tablet, or phone with at least 4 GB RAM and a modern browser | Used by dentists, clinic staff, and patients to access the web application. |
| Device Camera | Smartphone or digital camera capable of capturing still images | Takes the patient's still intraoral photograph, which is then uploaded to the screening page; no specialized intraoral camera hardware is required. |
| Internet Connection | Broadband or mobile data, 10 Mbps or higher recommended | Connects the clinic's devices to the cloud-hosted frontend, backend, and database. |
| Uninterruptible Power Supply | 600 VA minimum recommended | Keeps the clinic workstation and router running during short power interruptions. |

### 3.8 System Development

Toothwise was developed iteratively, following the six development phases in Table 11, applied repeatedly across the five documented iterations in Table 12 rather than as a single sequential build.

**Table 11 Development Phase Activities**

| Phase | Activities |
|---|---|
| 1. Planning and Requirements | Define the clinic workflow, user roles, screening objectives, AI detection needs, risk assessment, recommendation output, patient portal functions, security requirements, and reporting needs. |
| 2. System Analysis | Translate the requirements into frontend routes, FastAPI endpoints, database entities, AI modules, authentication dependencies, and data flows. |
| 3. System Design | Design the three-layer architecture, relational schema, JWT authentication model, detection-set structure, risk classification and recommendation flow, patient ownership checks, and cloud deployment. |
| 4. Development | Implement React pages and API services, FastAPI routers and schemas, SQLAlchemy models, PostgreSQL schema, YOLO detector |

| Phase | Activities |
|---|---|
| | integration, KNN risk classifier and recommender, reports, audit logs, and patient portal. |
| 5. Integration and Testing | Reconcile frontend requests with the actual backend contract, validate database enum labels and image paths, smoke-test API workflows, test security controls, and verify the frontend build. |
| 6. Deployment and Maintenance | Prepare the Neon PostgreSQL database, the Render backend service (which rebuilds the ONNX models from the repository at build time), the Vercel frontend build, environment secrets, database copies of screening photos, backups, and health monitoring. Continue maintenance through versioned changes, automatic redeploys on each push, and database migration scripts. |

**Table 12 Agile Iteration Summary**

| Iteration / Focus | Major Activities | Output |
|---|---|---|
| Iteration 1 – Core System Foundation | Initial React.js frontend, FastAPI backend, PostgreSQL schema, authentication, and core patient/dentist structures. | Working application foundation and authenticated API. |
| Iteration 2 – AI Screening | Integration of still-image upload, YOLO detection workflow, detection storage, risk scoring, and screening results. | End-to-end dental screening workflow. |
| Iteration 3 – Recommendations and Clinical Workflow | KNN risk classification and recommendation logic, prevention plans, clinical notes, screening details, and PDF reporting. | Expanded clinical screening and recommendation workflow. |
| Iteration 4 – Clinic Operations | Dashboard functions, staff management, audit logs, and patient portal features. | Broader clinic and patient workflows. |
| Iteration 5 – Testing, Hardening, and Deployment | API contract reconciliation, database and enum corrections, image access controls, rate limiting, validation, security headers, frontend integration fixes, cloud deployment on Vercel, Render, and Neon, ONNX Runtime inference, and database copies of screening photos. | Hardened, verified, and deployed system. |

Each iteration in Table 12 was carried through the full cycle shown earlier in Figure 1: the corresponding requirements were planned and analyzed, the affected parts of the system were designed, the frontend and backend components were developed and

integrated, the iteration's features were tested, the result was evaluated against the intended requirement, and any issue found was corrected before the next iteration began. The Gantt chart in Figure 7 visualizes this same sequence.

The system was implemented as a three-tier web application: a React.js single-page frontend, a FastAPI REST backend exposing versioned JSON endpoints, and a PostgreSQL relational database. The AI detection pipeline (YOLOv8 and YOLOv12) and the KNN-based risk classification and recommendation engine were developed as backend modules invoked synchronously by the screening endpoint. Each tier is deployed on its own free cloud service: the frontend on Vercel, the backend on Render, and the database on Neon. The complete technical specification of this architecture is presented in Section 4.2.

### 3.9 System Testing

Toothwise was tested through functional, integration, and security testing conducted against the running backend using FastAPI's TestClient, in an automated suite of 119 test cases (Section 4.2.5), supplemented by manual and code-review verification for checks that are not easily exercised through an automated client alone.

To confirm that Toothwise satisfies its intended functional requirements, a systematic software testing phase was conducted. This process evaluated module-level correctness, system-wide component interaction, and user acceptance, while specifically validating the accuracy of the YOLOv8/YOLOv12 detection pipeline and the KNN risk classification and recommendation engine in producing appropriate detections, risk classifications, and prevention plans based on patient screening data.

The system was evaluated using three structured testing tiers: Unit Testing (utilizing a white-box approach), Integration Testing (utilizing a gray-box approach), and User Acceptance Testing (utilizing a black-box approach). Structured test case matrices recorded the function under test, input parameters, expected behavior, actual results, and overall pass/fail status.

### 3.10 Evaluation Procedure

This section describes how the acceptability of Toothwise was evaluated (the fourth and fifth problems of the study): who the respondents were, the instrument they answered, how the data were gathered, and how the responses were treated. The results are presented in Sections 4.3 and 4.4.

#### 3.10.1 Respondents and Data Gathering

The evaluation questionnaire was prepared in Google Forms and shared online. Participation was voluntary: the form opened with a statement explaining the purpose of the study and the handling of the data, and only respondents who agreed to it could continue. Each respondent first stated their group, either patient respondent (a member of the public evaluating the system from a patient's point of view) or IT expert (IT practitioner), and then answered the parts of the questionnaire intended for them. The software quality part (ISO/IEC 25010) was written for dentists, clinic staff, and IT experts, while the parts on the system's features were written for all respondents. Responses were collected from October 19 to 28, 2026, and 103 complete submissions were received.

#### 3.10.2 Research Instrument

The instrument has eleven sections with 46 statements, listed in Table 13 and reproduced in full in Appendix A, plus three open-ended questions on what respondents liked, the difficulties they met, and the improvements they suggest. Six sections follow the quality characteristics named in the fourth problem of the study, three evaluate the system's main features, and two concern the current manual screening process and Toothwise's effect on screening consistency and time (the fifth problem).

**Table 13 Sections of the Evaluation Instrument**

| Section | Item codes | Items | Problem addressed |
|---|---|---|---|
| Security | SE1–SE4 | 4 | Problem 4 (quality characteristic) |

| Section | Item codes | Items | Problem addressed |
|---|---|---|---|
| Privacy | PR1–PR3 | 3 | Problem 4 (quality characteristic) |
| Usability | US1–US4 | 4 | Problem 4 (quality characteristic) |
| Reliability | RE1–RE3 | 3 | Problem 4 (quality characteristic) |
| Performance Efficiency | PE1–PE3 | 3 | Problem 4 (quality characteristic) |
| Data Protection | DP1–DP3 | 3 | Problem 4 (quality characteristic) |
| AI Detection and Risk Classification | AD1–AD5 | 5 | Problems 1 and 4 |
| Results Interface and Patient Records | RI1–RI5 | 5 | Problems 2 and 4 |
| KNN-Based Personalized Prevention Plan | PP1–PP4 | 4 | Problems 3 and 4 |
| Current Manual Screening Process | MS1–MS7 | 7 | Problem 1 (current process) |
| Screening Consistency and Time | SC1–SC5 | 5 | Problem 5 |
| Total | | 46 | |

### 3.10.3 Rating Scale and Interpretation

Each statement is rated on a four-point Likert scale with no neutral option, so every respondent states either agreement or disagreement. The weighted mean of each statement and section is interpreted using the ranges in Table 14, which divide the 1-to-4 range into four equal intervals of 0.75.

**Table 14 Four-Point Likert Scale and Verbal Interpretation**

| Scale | Mean range | Verbal interpretation | Acceptability |
|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | 3.26 – 4.00 | Strongly Agree | Highly Acceptable |
| 3 | 2.51 – 3.25 | Agree | Acceptable |
| 2 | 1.76 – 2.50 | Disagree | Slightly Acceptable |
| 1 | 1.00 – 1.75 | Strongly Disagree | Not Acceptable |

### 3.10.4 Statistical Treatment

The weighted mean of each statement is computed as WM = Σ(f × x) / N, where f is the number of respondents who chose a rating, x is the rating (1 to 4), and N is the number of respondents who answered the statement. The mean of a section is the average of its statement means, and the overall mean is the average of the section means. The standard deviation (SD) of the ratings shows how closely the respondents agreed with one another: the smaller the SD, the more uniform the ratings.

### 3.10.5 Ethical Considerations

All respondents gave their informed consent before answering. The questionnaire asked for a name only as an optional field; names are not reported anywhere in this paper, and results are presented only as group statistics. No patient records or photographs from CodiSmile Dental Clinic were collected for the evaluation, and all data were handled in accordance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173). The screening images shown in this paper are demonstration images.

### 3.11 Full Current System Screenshots

This section documents the current Toothwise system as implemented, one screen per numbered figure, in the order a user would encounter them: the public landing page, the staff and patient sign-in pages, password recovery and change, the dashboard, patient management, the screening workflow and results, staff management, the audit log, the rest of the patient portal, and the PDF screening report. The screenshots were captured from a running instance of the current system in light mode, using demonstration accounts, demonstration patients, and sample intraoral photographs taken from CodiSmile Dental Clinic's own published before-and-after images; no patient records are shown.

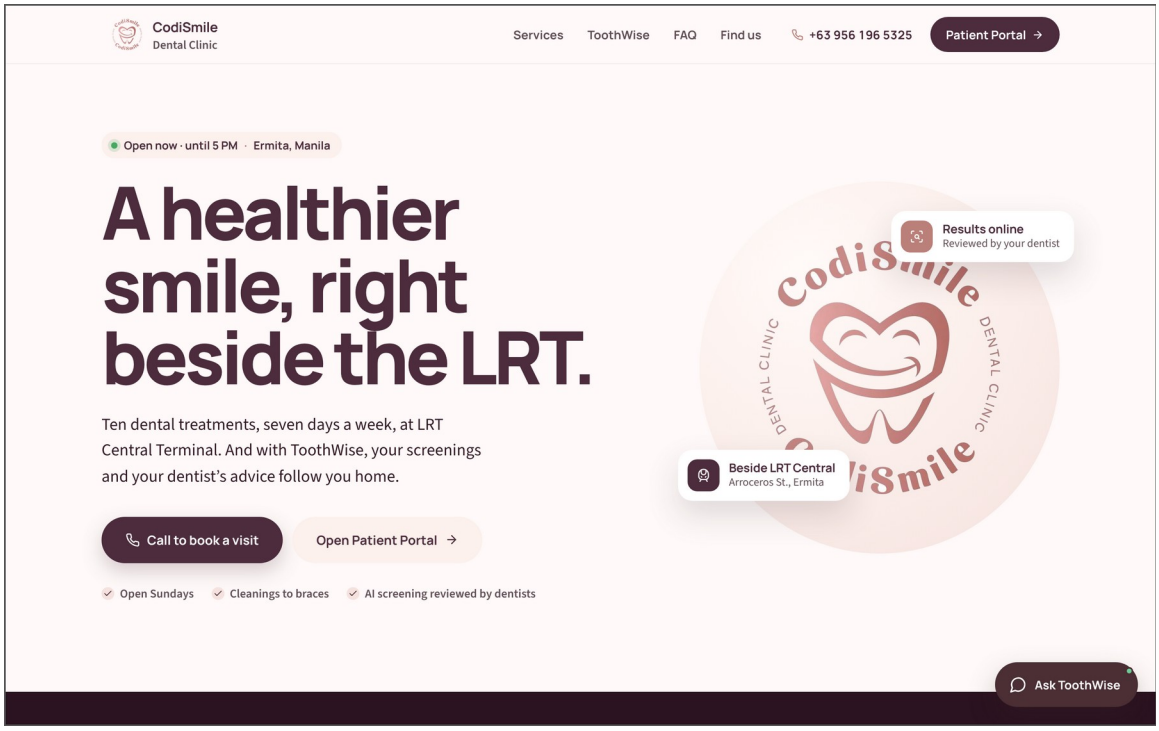



**Figure 8 Public Landing Page.** *This is the first page guests see. It introduces CodiSmile Dental Clinic and Toothwise, gives the clinic's location and opening hours, links to the patient portal, and opens the AI assistant.*

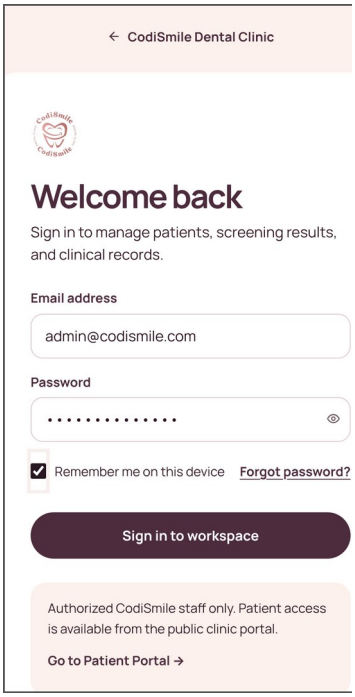



**Figure 9 Staff Login Page.** *Staff sign-in with "Remember me on this device" (30 days).*

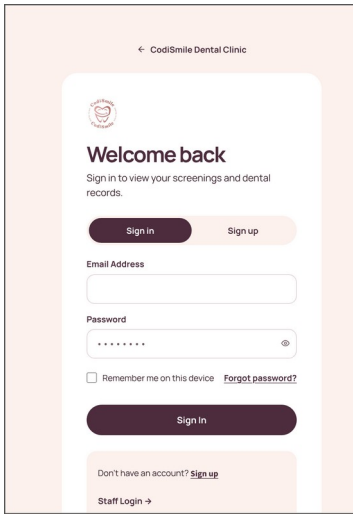



**Figure 10 Patient Portal — Sign In.** *Patients sign in to see only their own records.*

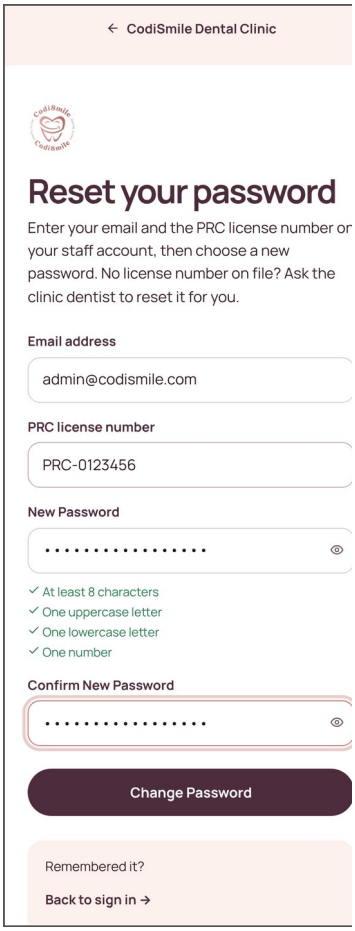



**Figure 11 Reset Password (Staff).** *Staff confirm their email and PRC license number, then set a new password.*

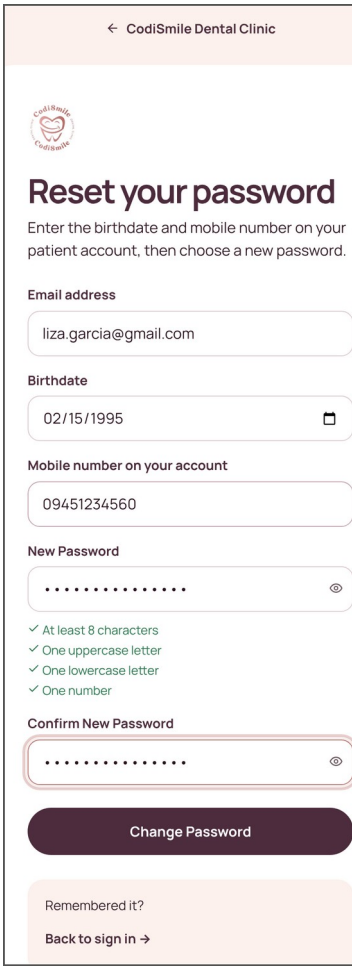



**Figure 12 Reset Password (Patient).** *Patients confirm their email, birthdate, and mobile number, then set a new password.*

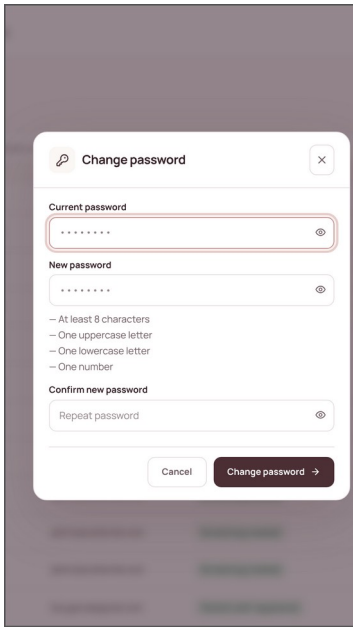



**Figure 13 Change Password.** *Opened from the sidebar or portal header; needs the current password.*

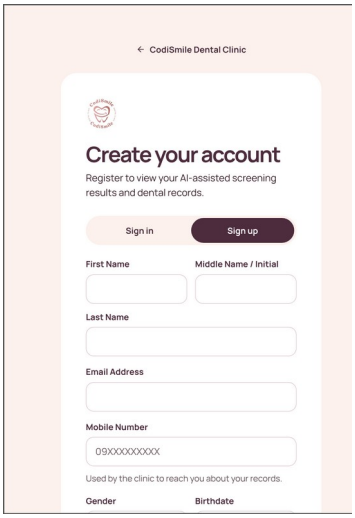



**Figure 14 Patient Portal — Sign Up.** *New patients create an account with their contact details and a password.*

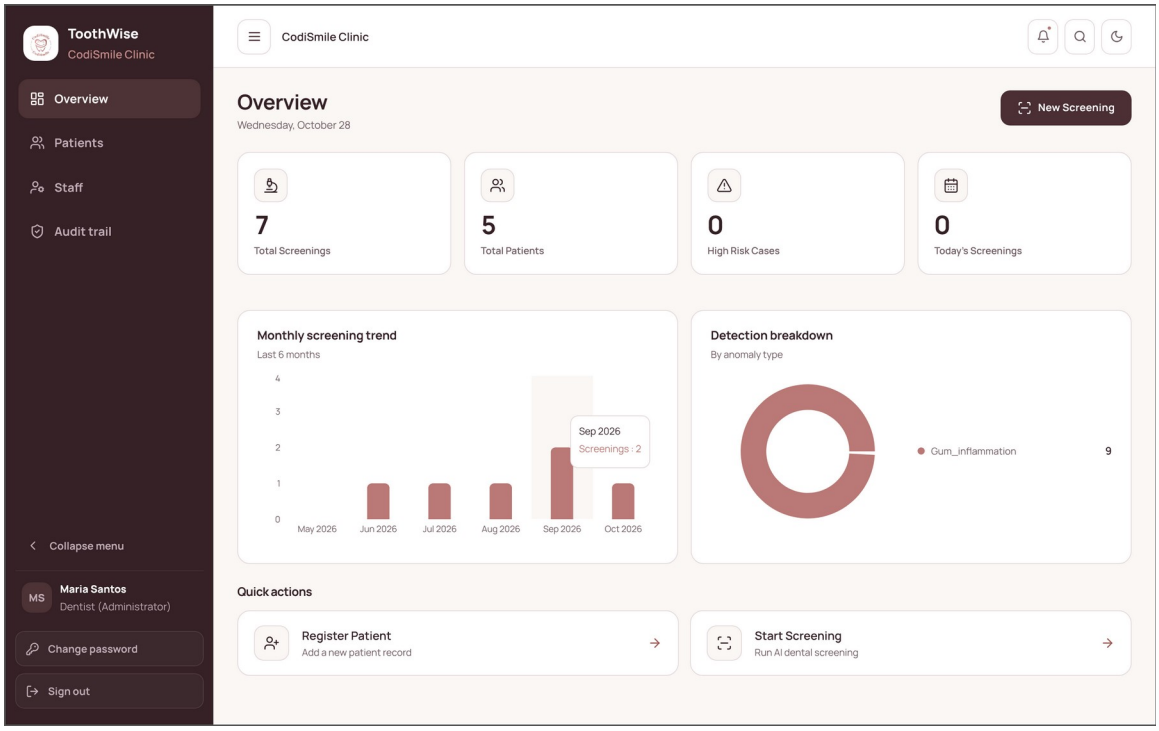



**Figure 15 Dashboard.** *The first screen staff see after signing in. It summarizes total screenings, patients, high-risk cases, and today's screenings, and shows the monthly screening trend and the breakdown of detected conditions.*

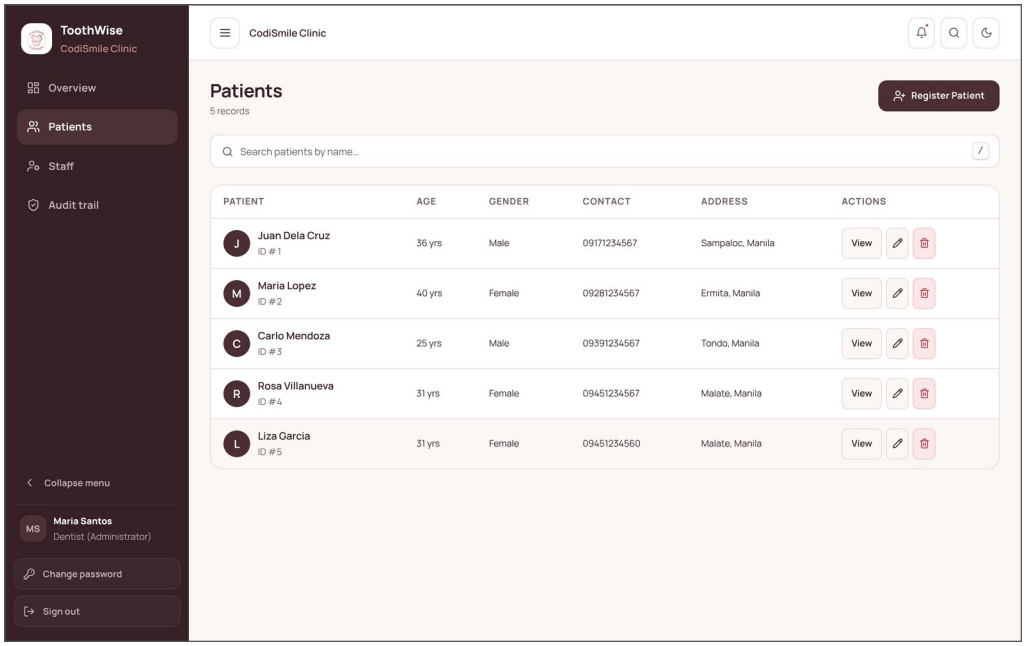



**Figure 16 Patient List.** *Lists every registered patient with age, gender, contact number, and address. Staff can search, register a patient, open a record, edit it, or (as dentist) delete it.*

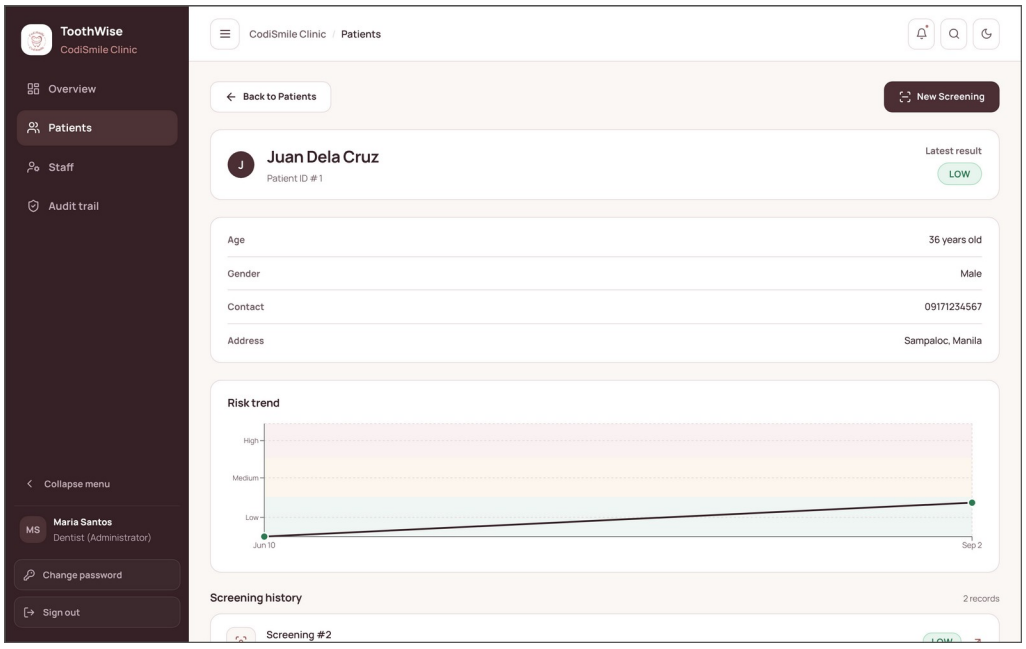



**Figure 17 Patient Details.** *The record of one patient: demographic details, the latest risk result, the risk trend across visits, and the screening history.*

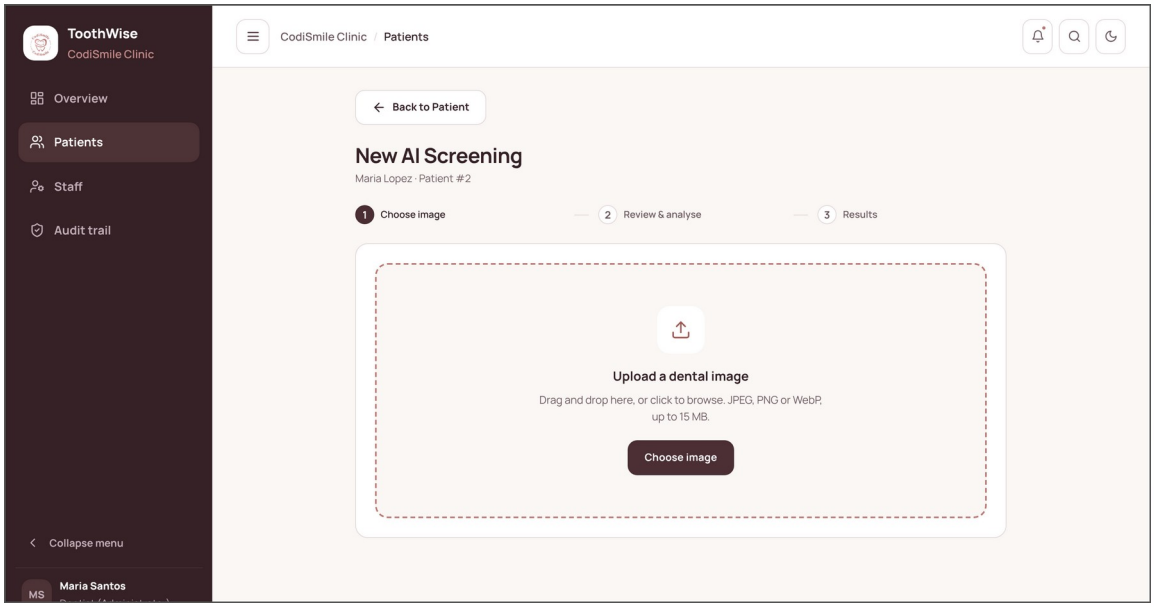



**Figure 18 New Screening (Step 1: Choose Image).** *Staff drag and drop or browse for the patient's intraoral photograph (JPEG, PNG, or WebP, up to 15 MB).*

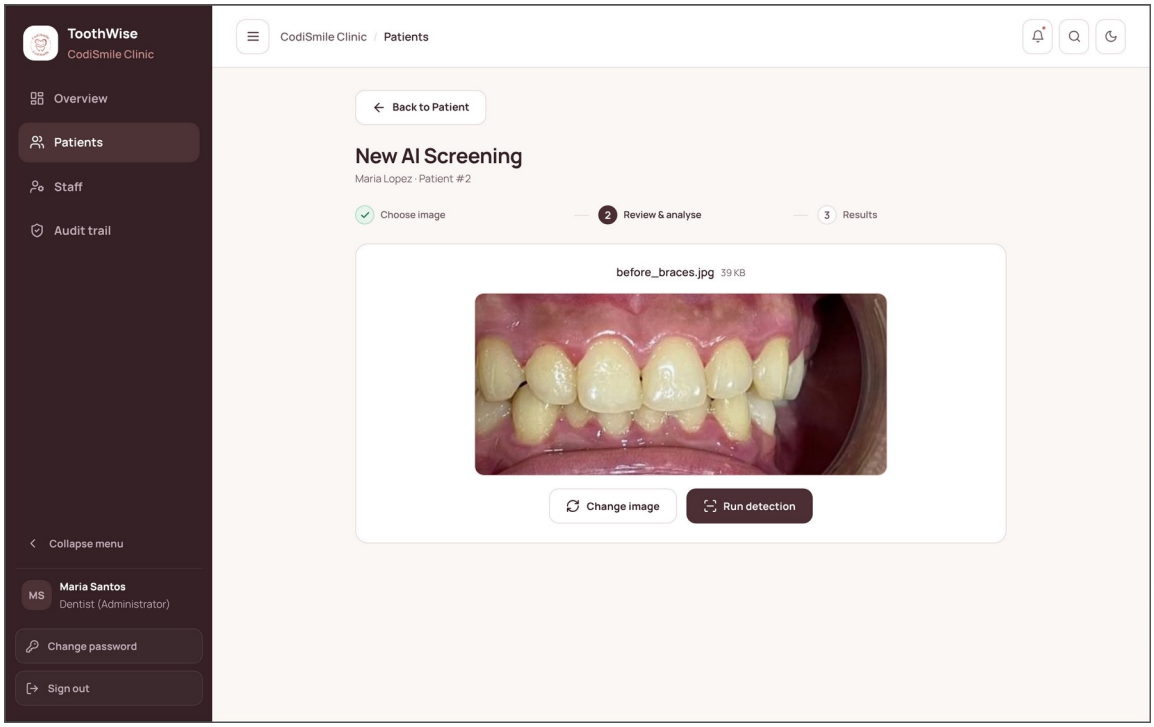



**Figure 19 New Screening (Step 2: Review and Analyse).** *The selected photograph is shown for checking before the YOLOv8 and YOLOv12 ensemble is run.*

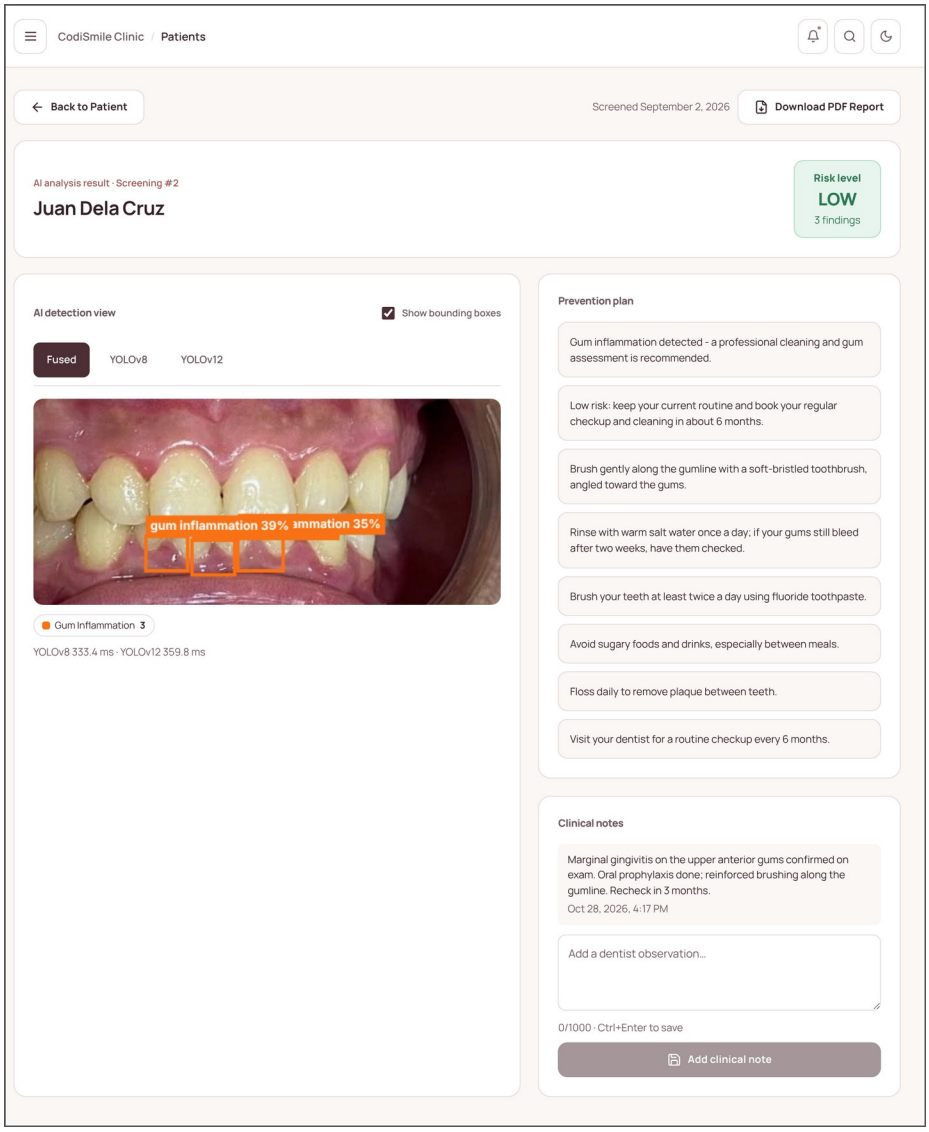



**Figure 20 Screening Results.** *The analysis of the uploaded photograph: color-coded bounding boxes for the fused, YOLOv8, and YOLOv12 detections (here, gum inflammation), the risk level, the prevention plan, the dentist's clinical notes, and the button that downloads the PDF report.*

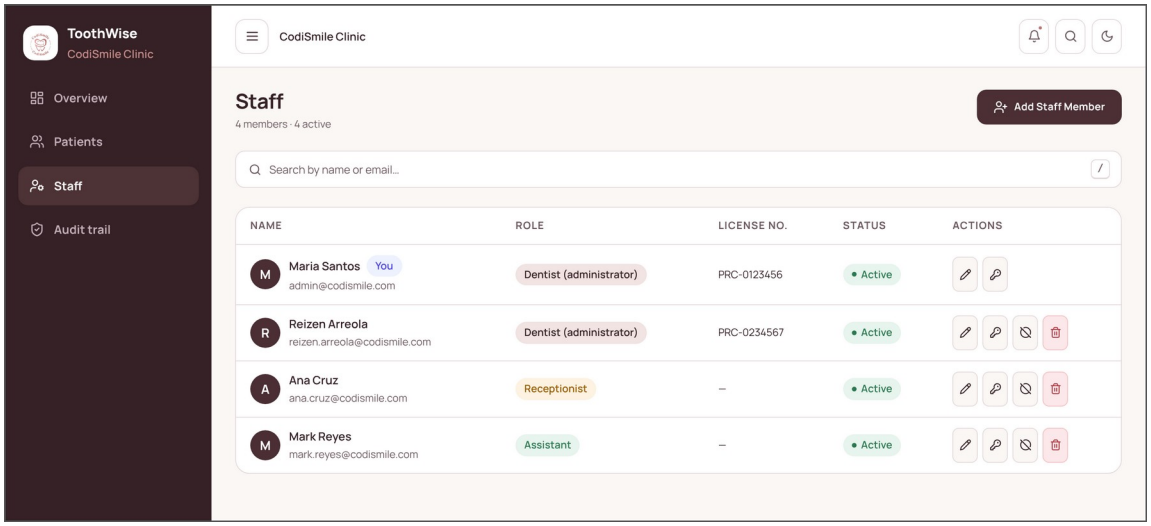



**Figure 21 Staff Management (Dentist/Administrator).** *Lets the dentist add staff members, assign the dentist, receptionist, or assistant role, edit details, reset passwords, and deactivate or delete accounts.*

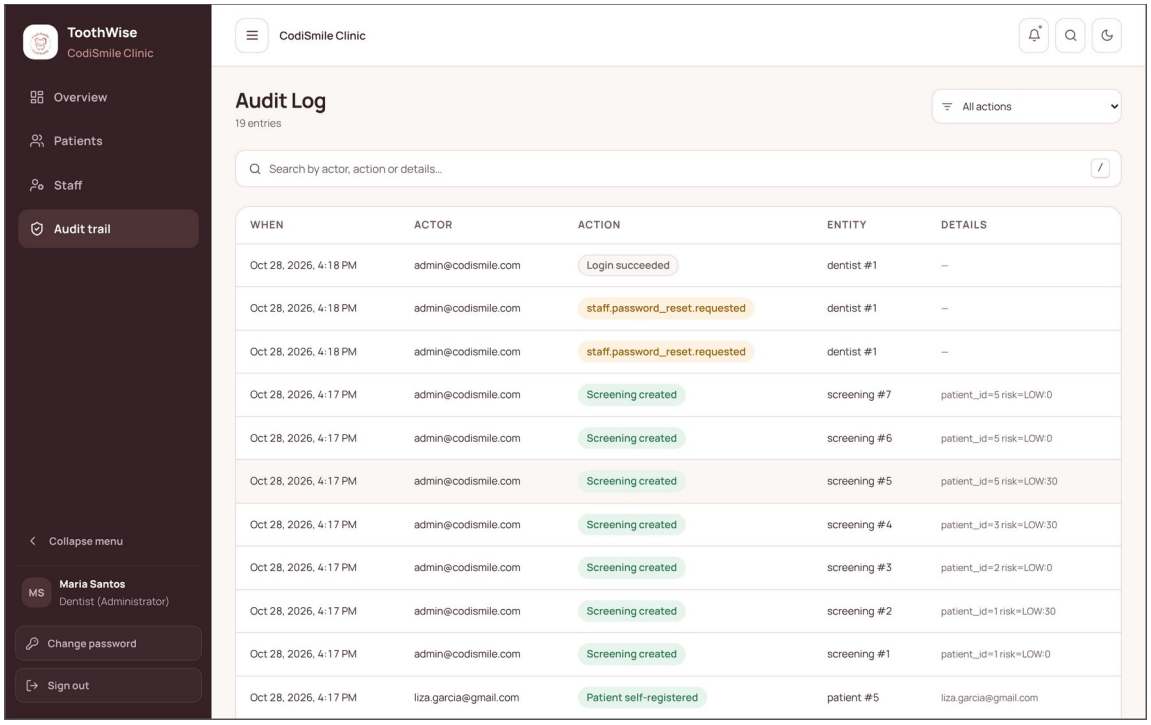



**Figure 22 Audit Log (Dentist/Administrator).** *A permanent, filterable timeline of who signed in, reset or changed a password, and created, changed, or deleted records, and when.*

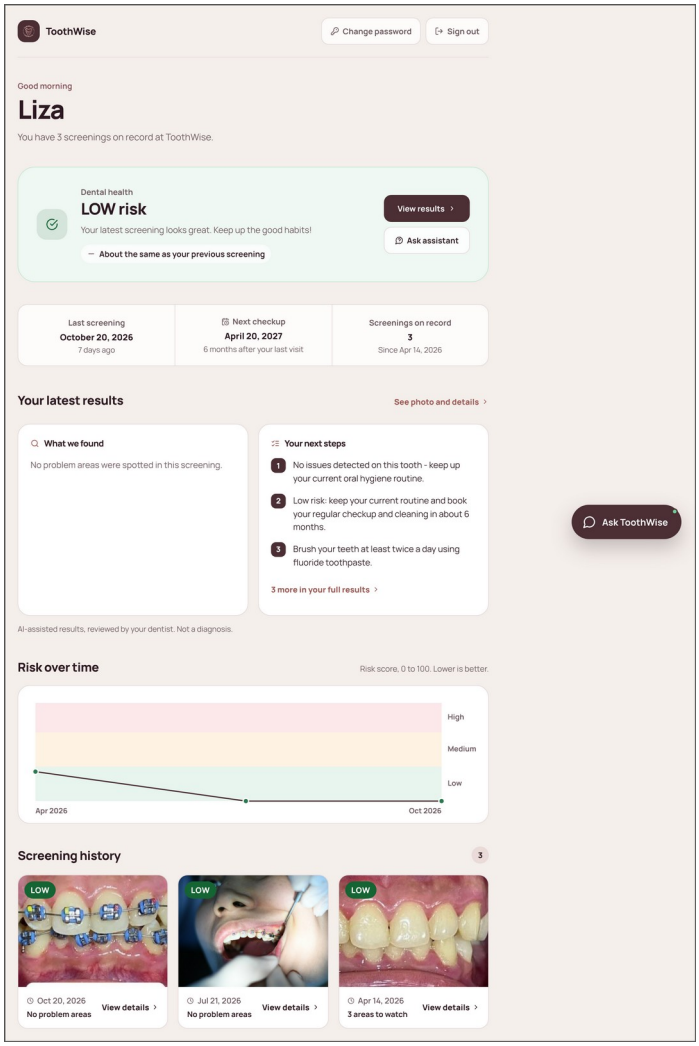



**Figure 23 Patient Portal — Home.** *Latest risk level and change since the last visit, next check-up date, latest findings and next steps, risk over time, and screening history.*

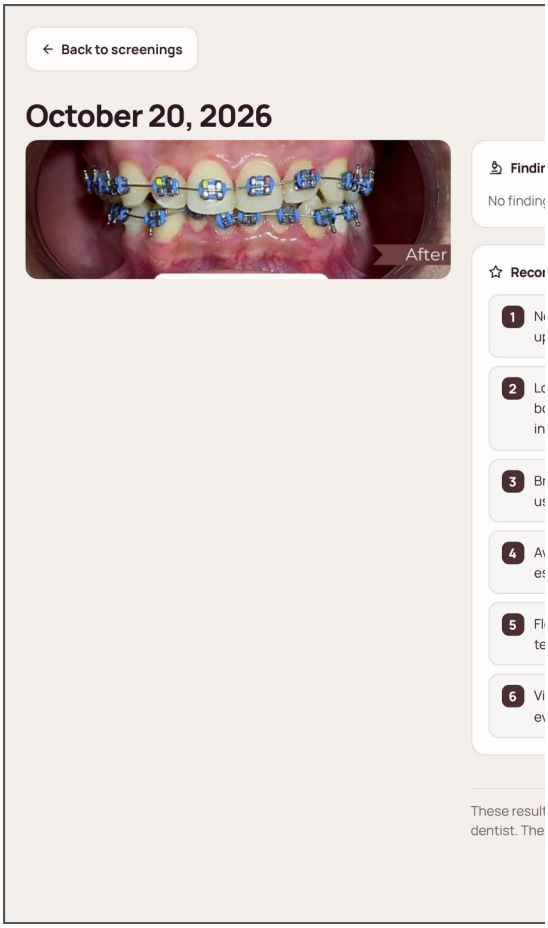
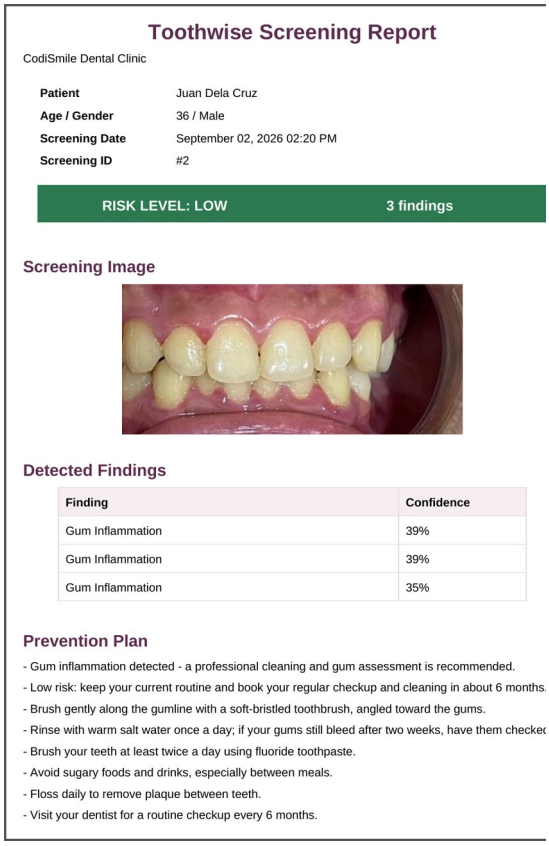



**Figure 24 Patient Portal — Screening Details.** *One screening: the photograph with its findings and the prevention plan.*



Toothwise Screening Report

CodiSmile Dental Clinic

| | |
|---|---|
| Patient | Juan Dela Cruz |
| Age / Gender | 36 / Male |
| Screening Date | September 02, 2026 02:20 PM |
| Screening ID | #2 |

RISK LEVEL: LOW — 3 findings

Screening Image

Detected Findings

| Finding | Confidence |
|---|---|
| Gum Inflammation | 39% |
| Gum Inflammation | 39% |
| Gum Inflammation | 35% |

Prevention Plan

- Gum inflammation detected - a professional cleaning and gum assessment is recommended.
- Low risk: keep your current routine and book your regular checkup and cleaning in about 6 months.
- Brush gently along the gumline with a soft-bristled toothbrush, angled toward the gums.
- Rinse with warm salt water once a day; if your gums still bleed after two weeks, have them checked
- Brush your teeth at least twice a day using fluoride toothpaste.
- Avoid sugary foods and drinks, especially between meals.
- Floss daily to remove plaque between teeth.
- Visit your dentist for a routine checkup every 6 months.

**Figure 25 PDF Screening Report.** *First page of the report: patient details, risk level, image, findings, and prevention plan.*

# CHAPTER IV

# RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

This chapter presents the results of the study. It follows the five problems in Chapter I: how well the trained models detect the five dental conditions (Section 4.1, Problem 1), how the finished system records findings and gives prevention advice (Section 4.2, Problems 2 and 3), how the respondents rated the system (Section 4.3, Problem 4), and how the respondents judged its effect on screening consistency and time (Section 4.4, Problem 5). Sections 4.3 and 4.4 are based on the answers of 103 respondents.

## 4.1 Results of the Trained Datasets

This section answers the first problem: how accurately can the trained models find tartar, plaque, cavity, gum inflammation, and healthy tooth in an ordinary photograph of the teeth, and which of the two models, YOLOv8 or YOLOv12, does it better and faster?

### 4.1.1 Dataset Preparation

The models learned from four free, public collections of dental photographs in which the conditions had already been marked by hand. Each collection named its conditions differently, so every condition was matched to one of the five Toothwise classes, and conditions outside the study (for example, missing teeth, crooked teeth, gaps, ulcers, and missing tooth buds) were left out. Some collections outlined each condition as a shape instead of a box, so those outlines were turned into boxes, which is the format both models use. Table 15 shows how each collection's conditions were matched.

**Table 15 Source Datasets and Class Remapping to the Toothwise Taxonomy**

| Source dataset (export) | Original classes | Mapped to Toothwise class | Dropped classes |
|---|---|---|---|
| dadad12 (v3) | calculus, cavities, maligned, missing, plaque, spacing, stains | calculus → tartar; cavities → cavity; plaque → plaque | maligned, missing, spacing, stains |

| Source dataset (export) | Original classes | Mapped to Toothwise class | Dropped classes |
|---|---|---|---|
| DenPal (v8) | Caries, Missing Tooth, Tartar | Caries → cavity; Tartar → tartar | Missing Tooth |
| oral-diseases (v2) | calculus, caries, gingivitis, hypodontia, tooth_discolation, ulcer | calculus → tartar; caries → cavity; gingivitis → gum_inflammation | hypodontia, tooth_discolation, ulcer |
| Teeth 2 (v1) | Caries, Cavity, Healthy | Caries → cavity; Cavity → cavity; Healthy → healthy_tooth | None |

*Source: class lists and remap printed by the YOLOv12 training notebook (train_dental_yolov12_5class_2.ipynb).*

The combined collection was split into three parts (Table 16): a training set that the models learn from, a validation set used to check progress during training, and a test set that the models never see until the final evaluation. Photographs that showed none of the five conditions were kept, because they teach the models not to mark healthy areas by mistake.

**Table 16 Merged Dataset Split**

| Split | Images | Background images (no target label) | Share of images |
|---|---|---|---|
| Training | 40,271 | 10,791 | 83.0% |
| Validation | 5,299 | 2,833 | 10.9% |
| Test | 2,930 | 1,067 | 6.0% |
| Total | 48,500 | 14,691 | 100.0% |

*Label rows written during the merge: 86,028 bounding boxes and 7,457 polygons converted to boxes (93,485 in total). Test background count taken from the rebuilt test split.*

Table 17 shows how many examples of each condition the test set contains. The numbers are very uneven, from 42 healthy-tooth examples to 2,716 cavity examples, and this unevenness affects the results later in this section.

**Table 17 Labeled Instances per Class (Test Split, 2,930 Images)**

| Class | Images containing the class | Labeled instances | Share of instances |
|---|---|---|---|
| Healthy tooth | 39 | 42 | 0.6% |

| Class | Images containing the class | Labeled instances | Share of instances |
|---|---|---|---|
| Cavity | 1,190 | 2,716 | 39.6% |
| Gum inflammation | 297 | 1,544 | 22.5% |
| Plaque | 147 | 554 | 8.1% |
| Tartar | 558 | 2,009 | 29.3% |
| Total | — | 6,865 | 100.0% |

*Counted from the rebuilt test split (same source order, class remap, and polygon-to-box conversion as the training notebook).*

### 4.1.2 Training Configuration

Both models were trained on the same data with the same settings, so that the comparison between them is fair. Training ran on Google Colab with an NVIDIA Tesla T4 graphics card, and whenever the Colab session disconnected, training continued from the last saved point. Table 18 lists the settings, read directly from the saved models.

**Table 18 Training Configuration of the Two Detection Models**

| Parameter | YOLOv8 | YOLOv12 |
|---|---|---|
| Model scale | YOLOv8m (medium; depth 0.67, width 0.75) | YOLOv12m (medium) |
| Trainable parameters | 25,859,215 | 19,662,111 |
| Pretrained starting weights | Yes (COCO) | Yes (COCO) |
| Classes | 5 | 5 |
| Epochs | 60 | 60 |
| Image size | 640 × 640 px | 640 × 640 px |
| Batch size | 12 | 12 |
| Optimizer | auto (selected by Ultralytics) | auto (MuSGD, lr 0.01, momentum 0.9) |
| Early-stopping patience | 15 epochs | 15 epochs |
| Random seed | 0 | 0 |
| Ultralytics version | 8.4.146 | 8.4.160 |
| Training hardware | Google Colab, NVIDIA Tesla T4 (15 GB) | Google Colab, NVIDIA Tesla T4 (15 GB) |
| Checkpoint date (UTC) | 2026-09-10 | 2026-09-23 |

### 4.1.3 Overall Detection Performance of YOLOv8 and YOLOv12

Five standard measures are used to score the models. **Precision** is the share of the model's marks that are correct: of all the boxes it drew, how many were real findings. **Recall** is the share of real findings that the model found: of all the conditions in the photographs, how many it marked. The **F1-score** combines precision and recall into one number. **mAP@50** (mean average precision) is the main overall score: it counts a finding as found when the model's box overlaps the correct box by at least half, and averages the result over the five conditions. **mAP@50-95** is the same score with stricter overlap rules, so it is always lower. For all five measures, higher is better, and 100% would be perfect.

Table 19 gives the scores on two sets of photographs: the validation set (5,299 images), scored at the end of training, and the test set (2,930 images), which neither model had seen before. The test-set scores are the fairest comparison.

**Table 19 Overall Detection Performance of YOLOv8 and YOLOv12**

| Metric | YOLOv8 (validation) | YOLOv12 (validation) | YOLOv8 (test) | YOLOv12 (test) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Precision | 53.96% | 49.43% | 54.32% | 52.94% |
| Recall | 49.73% | 49.05% | 52.34% | 50.06% |
| F1-score | 51.76% | 49.24% | 53.31% | 51.46% |
| mAP@50 | 46.83% | 45.02% | 51.91% | 48.11% |
| mAP@50-95 | 26.80% | 25.87% | 28.53% | 26.28% |

*Validation: train_metrics stored in the checkpoints (epoch 60). Test: one prediction pass over the held-out test split (confidence 0.001, NMS IoU 0.70, image size 640), scored with the Ultralytics matching rule.*

YOLOv8 scored a little higher than YOLOv12 on every measure. On the test set, its mAP@50 was 51.91% against 48.11% for YOLOv12, its precision 54.32% against 52.94%, and its recall 52.34% against 50.06%. In simple terms, each model correctly found about half of the conditions in the test photographs. YOLOv12 is the smaller model: it reached these results with about 24% fewer parameters (19.66 million against 25.86 million), which makes it lighter to run.

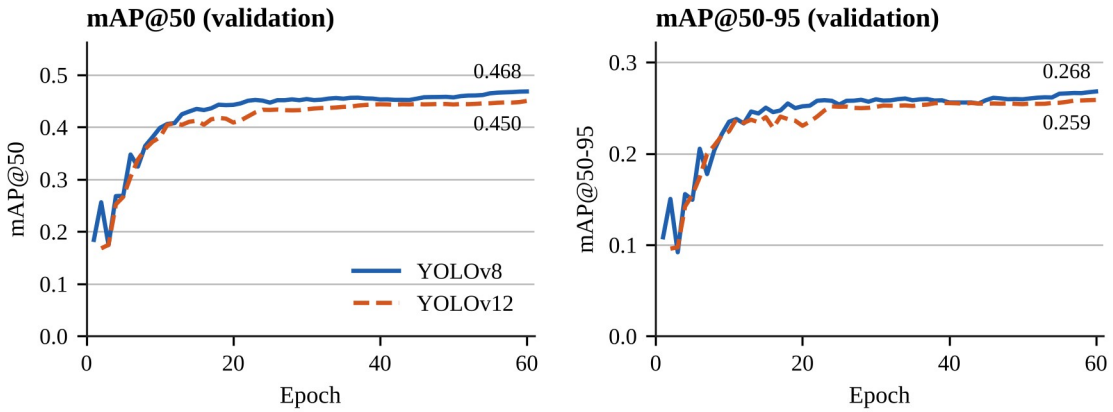



**Figure 26 mAP@50 and mAP@50-95 per Training Epoch for YOLOv8 and YOLOv12.**

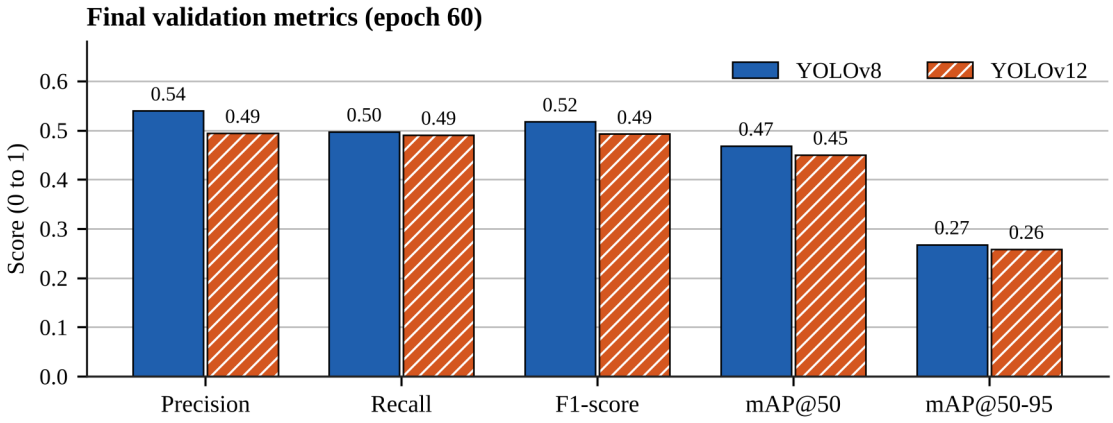



**Figure 27 Final Validation Metrics of YOLOv8 and YOLOv12.**

Figure 26 shows how the scores grew during training. Both models improved quickly in the first ten rounds of training (epochs) and then levelled off; after about round 25, the score rose by only about two more percentage points. This means that training longer would not help much; better results need more and better training photographs.

### 4.1.4 Per-Class Detection Results

Tables 20 and 21 break the scores down by condition, and Figure 28 compares the two models and the combined (fused) result for each condition.

**Table 20 Per-Class Detection Performance of YOLOv8 (Test Split)**

| Class | Instances | Precision | Recall | F1-score | mAP@50 | mAP@50-95 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Healthy tooth | 42 | 42.86% | 83.33% | 56.60% | 80.54% | 62.37% |
| Cavity | 2,716 | 65.55% | 69.43% | 67.43% | 66.33% | 33.11% |
| Gum inflammation | 1,544 | 61.01% | 49.85% | 54.87% | 52.35% | 21.97% |
| Plaque | 554 | 42.84% | 7.04% | 12.09% | 7.36% | 3.06% |
| Tartar | 2,009 | 59.33% | 52.07% | 55.46% | 52.97% | 22.15% |
| All classes | 6,865 | 54.32% | 52.34% | 53.31% | 51.91% | 28.53% |

*Source: test-split evaluation pass, scored with the Ultralytics matching rule.*

**Table 21 Per-Class Detection Performance of YOLOv12 (Test Split)**

| Class | Instances | Precision | Recall | F1-score | mAP@50 | mAP@50-95 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Healthy tooth | 42 | 43.40% | 78.57% | 55.91% | 70.13% | 54.83% |
| Cavity | 2,716 | 62.82% | 69.26% | 65.88% | 64.50% | 32.27% |
| Gum inflammation | 1,544 | 60.59% | 45.60% | 52.04% | 48.95% | 20.16% |
| Plaque | 554 | 39.55% | 8.30% | 13.73% | 7.15% | 3.52% |
| Tartar | 2,009 | 58.34% | 48.59% | 53.03% | 49.82% | 20.62% |
| All classes | 6,865 | 52.94% | 50.06% | 51.46% | 48.11% | 26.28% |

*Source: test-split evaluation pass, scored with the Ultralytics matching rule.*

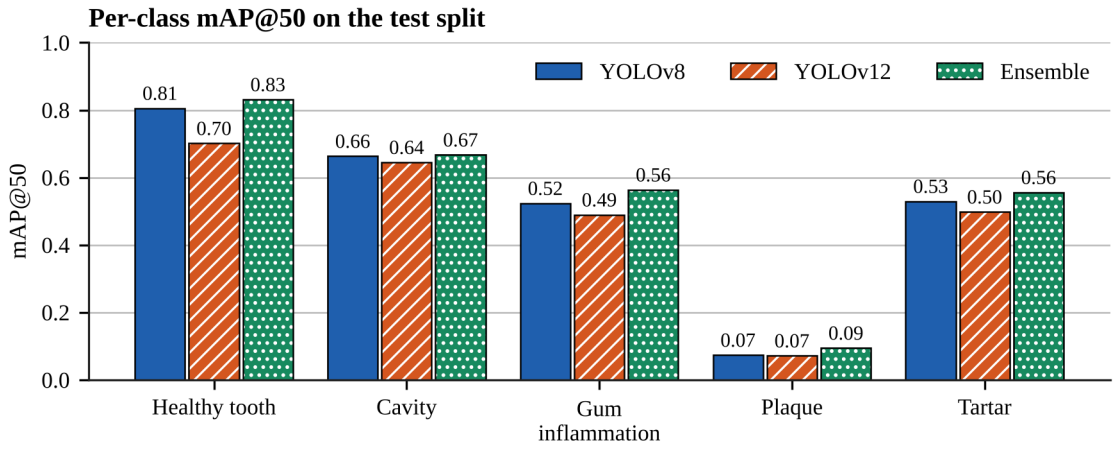



**Figure 28 Per-Class mAP@50 on the Test Split.**

The models are much better at some conditions than others. Among the conditions with many examples, cavity was found best (mAP@50 of 66.33% for YOLOv8 and

64.50% for YOLOv12) and plaque worst (7.36% and 7.15%). From best to worst, the order was healthy tooth, cavity, tartar, gum inflammation, and plaque. Healthy tooth scored highest (80.54% and 70.13%), but the test set has only 42 healthy-tooth examples, so that score is less certain than the others.

Plaque is the main weakness of the models. Of the 554 plaque examples in the test set, YOLOv8 found only 7.04% and YOLOv12 8.30%. There are several reasons. Plaque is a thin, pale film that is hard to tell apart from the tooth and from tartar in an ordinary photograph; its edges are hard to mark consistently, so the model's box rarely overlaps the marked box enough to count; only one of the four photo collections marked plaque at all; and there are about five times fewer plaque examples (554) than cavity examples (2,716). These are the same reasons, named in the first problem of this study, why plaque is hard to judge by eye.

### 4.1.5 Detection Accuracy and Confusion Matrix

Detection has no single built-in accuracy score, because a model can go wrong in three ways: it can give a finding the wrong name, mark a spot where there is nothing (a false alarm), or miss a finding completely. In this study, **detection accuracy** is the number of findings that were found and named correctly, divided by all four outcomes together (correct, wrong name, false alarm, and missed). The counts were taken at the same confidence setting that the live system uses (0.25). Tables 22 and 23 give the results, and Figure 29 shows the confusion matrices, which show how often each condition was mistaken for another.

**Table 22 Detection Accuracy on the Test Split (Confidence 0.25, IoU 0.45)**

| Model | Correct | Wrong class | False alarms | Missed | Detection accuracy |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| YOLOv8 | 3,877 | 114 | 1,992 | 2,874 | 43.77% |
| YOLOv12 | 3,726 | 119 | 2,039 | 3,020 | 41.85% |
| Fused ensemble | 4,491 | 158 | 3,574 | 2,216 | 43.02% |

*Detection accuracy = Correct / (Correct + Wrong class + False alarms + Missed).*

**Table 23 Detection Accuracy per Class on the Test Split**

| Class | YOLOv8 | YOLOv12 | Fused ensemble |
|---|---|---|---|
| Healthy tooth | 38.20% | 39.29% | 33.94% |
| Cavity | 52.87% | 51.38% | 49.83% |
| Gum inflammation | 40.53% | 37.16% | 42.25% |
| Plaque | 6.46% | 7.58% | 10.46% |
| Tartar | 40.52% | 38.01% | 39.54% |

*Per class: correct detections of the class divided by all detections and labels of that class (correct + wrong + false alarms + missed).*

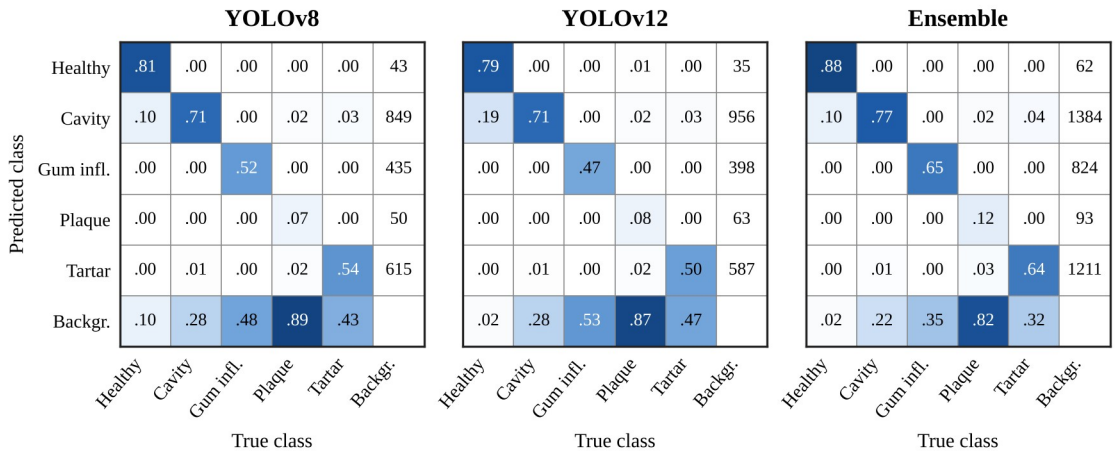



**Figure 29 Confusion Matrices on the Test Split (Columns Normalized by True Class).**

Detection accuracy was 43.77% for YOLOv8, 41.85% for YOLOv12, and 43.02% for the combined result. For both models, the most common mistake was missing a finding. Giving a finding the wrong name was rare, so when a model does find a condition, it usually names it correctly. The most common mix-up between two conditions was tartar being called a cavity.

The combined result had slightly lower accuracy than YOLOv8 even though its mAP@50 was higher (Section 4.1.7). The reason is that it keeps a finding when either model reports it. It therefore missed fewer findings (2,216 against 2,874) but raised more

false alarms (3,574 against 1,992). Detection accuracy counts both kinds of mistake equally, while mAP rewards placing correct findings ahead of wrong ones.

Two cautions apply. First, the four photo collections did not all mark the same conditions; for example, a photograph from a collection without a gum-inflammation label may show inflamed gums that nobody marked. When the model correctly finds them, the count treats it as a false alarm, so the real accuracy is probably somewhat higher. Second, the counts depend on the confidence setting: a lower setting finds more but also raises more false alarms.

For a screening tool, a missed finding is the more serious mistake: a false alarm is simply checked and dismissed by the dentist, but a missed finding might not be looked at. This is why Toothwise presents its detections as suggestions and keeps the dentist's own examination as the final word.

### 4.1.6 Inference Speed

Speed was measured on an ordinary computer without a graphics card, like the computers in a clinic. Each model analyzed four sample photographs five times each, after one warm-up run. Table 24 gives the average time per photograph.

**Table 24 Inference Time per Image on CPU**

| Configuration | Mean time per image | Standard deviation | Model forward pass only |
|---|---|---|---|
| YOLOv8 | 215.9 ms | 8.9 ms | 203.7 ms |
| YOLOv12 | 206.5 ms | 7.6 ms | 198.9 ms |
| Both models (ensemble, run in sequence) | 506.8 ms | 138.7 ms | — |

*Machine: Intel Core i7-13620H, 16 GB RAM, CPU only (PyTorch 2.14 CPU, Ultralytics 8.4.116); n = 20 timed predictions per configuration.*

Each model analyzed a photograph in about one fifth of a second; YOLOv12 was about 4% faster than YOLOv8. Running both models one after the other took about half a second. This is fast enough for a dentist to upload a photograph and see the results right away.

The live system runs on a smaller, free cloud server with only 512 MB of memory. To fit, it uses a lighter copy of the same two models (ONNX format) and loads each model only while it is working. On that server, a full screening with both models takes about 3 to 4 seconds, and the system uses about 210 MB of memory at rest and about 400 MB at its busiest. The lighter models gave exactly the same results as the originals on 22 test photographs, so the accuracy results in this chapter also apply to the live system. A wait of a few seconds is acceptable because a photograph is uploaded only once per screening.

### 4.1.7 Ensemble Fusion

In the live system, both models look at every photograph and their results are combined into one set of findings. When the two models mark the same condition in about the same place (their boxes overlap by at least half), the two boxes are merged into one. A finding that both models agree on is given a slightly higher confidence (plus 0.08, up to 0.98), because two separately trained models agreeing is stronger evidence than one model alone.

To see whether combining helps, the whole test set was run through both models, and the YOLOv8 results, the YOLOv12 results, and the combined results were scored the same way. Table 25 shows the result.

**Table 25 YOLOv8, YOLOv12, and the Fused Ensemble on the Test Split**

| Metric | YOLOv8 | YOLOv12 | Fused ensemble |
|---|---|---|---|
| Precision | 54.32% | 52.94% | 53.51% |
| Recall | 52.34% | 50.06% | 55.77% |
| F1-score | 53.31% | 51.46% | 54.62% |
| mAP@50 | 51.91% | 48.11% | 54.24% |
| mAP@50-95 | 28.53% | 26.28% | 29.31% |
| mAP@50 – healthy tooth | 80.54% | 70.13% | 83.11% |
| mAP@50 – cavity | 66.33% | 64.50% | 66.72% |
| mAP@50 – gum inflammation | 52.35% | 48.95% | 56.36% |

| Metric | YOLOv8 | YOLOv12 | Fused ensemble |
|---|---|---|---|
| mAP@50 – plaque | 7.36% | 7.15% | 9.45% |
| mAP@50 – tartar | 52.97% | 49.82% | 55.58% |

*Same prediction pass as Tables 19 to 21; the single-model columns repeat those results.*

Combining the two models gave the best mAP@50, 54.24%, compared with 51.91% for the better single model, YOLOv8, an improvement of 2.34 percentage points, and it was better than YOLOv8 on all five conditions. It found more of the real findings (recall 55.77% against 52.34%) at almost the same precision (53.51% against 54.32%). It missed fewer findings (2,216 against 2,874) but raised more false alarms (3,574 against 1,992).

In other words, each model catches some findings that the other misses, and when both agree, the finding is more trustworthy. This supports the decision to run both models in the live system instead of choosing just one.

### 4.1.8 Summary of the Model Comparison

To answer the first problem: both models learned to find the five conditions. YOLOv8 was slightly more accurate (mAP@50 of 51.91% against 48.11%), while YOLOv12 was smaller and slightly faster (about 206 ms against 216 ms per photograph). The difference between the two models is small compared with the difference between conditions: cavity was found reliably, but plaque was hard for both. Combining the models gave the best result (mAP@50 of 54.24%, detection accuracy 43.02%). These results confirm what Chapter I states: Toothwise is a screening aid, not a replacement for the dentist. Its findings are suggestions that the dentist confirms or corrects.

## 4.2 Specialization and Technical Results

This section describes how the finished system works and how well it performed: the screening steps, the risk score, the prevention plan, the patient records, user roles and security, the chatbot, and the speed and accessibility of the website.

### 4.2.1 AI Detection Pipeline

When staff upload a photograph of a patient's teeth, the system goes through six steps: (1) it checks that the file is a JPEG, PNG, or WebP image of at most 15 MB; (2) it runs YOLOv8 and YOLOv12; (3) it combines their findings (Section 4.1.7) and removes braces brackets that the models mistake for findings; (4) it computes a risk score and risk level; (5) it writes a prevention plan; and (6) it saves the photograph, every finding with its box and confidence, the risk result, and the plan in the patient's record. The live system also keeps a copy of each photograph in the database, because the free server erases its own files whenever it restarts; the copy is used to restore the photograph for viewing and for the PDF report.

Neither model learned what braces look like, so in early testing the metal brackets on teeth with braces were reported as urgent cavities. The system now ignores any cavity, plaque, or tartar box in which 8% or more of the pixels are metal-grey, reports a cavity only when its confidence is at least 0.50, and keeps a cavity only when both models find it. When two or more brackets are seen, the prevention plan adds a note that braces were detected and that a dentist or orthodontist should check those teeth in person. These rules were added after the accuracy tests in Section 4.1, so Tables 22, 23, and 25 show the results before the rules.

### 4.2.2 Risk Scoring Engine

The risk score follows a fixed rule, so that every score can be explained to the patient and checked by the dentist. Each condition has a severity weight, cavity being the most serious (Table 26). For each finding, the weight is multiplied by the model's confidence; the score is the highest of these values, plus 6 points for each additional finding (up to five more), with a maximum of 100. The score then decides the risk level: LOW, MEDIUM, or HIGH.

**Table 26 Risk Scoring Weights and Tier Thresholds**

| Class | Severity weight | Highest possible score from one finding |
|---|---|---|
| Healthy tooth | 0 | 0 (no risk contribution) |
| Plaque | 25 | 25 (LOW) |
| Tartar | 35 | 35 (MEDIUM) |
| Gum inflammation | 45 | 45 (MEDIUM) |
| Cavity | 70 | 70 (HIGH) |

*Tiers: LOW 0–34, MEDIUM 35–69, HIGH 70–100. Source: backend/app/ml/labels.py (SEVERITY_WEIGHT) and backend/app/ml/risk_engine.py.*

### 4.2.3 KNN-Based Recommendation Feature

The prevention plan uses a K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) classifier. In simple terms, KNN looks at the five past cases that are most similar to the current screening and uses them to decide its risk level; the plan is then written from that level and the specific conditions found. Because there were no dentist-checked cases yet, the classifier first learned from made-up (synthetic) cases created with the risk rule. Each time a dentist confirms or corrects a risk level in the system, that case is saved as a real example for future retraining.

Table 27 shows how the classifier did on 2,000 new made-up cases that it had not seen before. Since these cases follow the same rule it learned from, this test shows how well it copies the rule, not how accurate it is on real patients.

**Table 27 KNN Tier Classification on Unseen Synthetic Cases**

| Risk tier | Precision | Recall | F1-score | Cases |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| LOW | 98.35% | 96.30% | 97.31% | 864 |
| MEDIUM | 90.18% | 95.47% | 92.75% | 971 |
| HIGH | 76.19% | 58.18% | 65.98% | 165 |
| Overall (weighted) | — | — | 92.51% | 2,000 |

*Overall accuracy: 92.75%. Source: python -m app.ml.evaluate_knn (re-run on the current code with the same result).*

The classifier agreed with the rule on 92.75% of the cases. Most mistakes happened near the borders between levels. The weakest level was HIGH: 69 of 165 HIGH

cases were put in MEDIUM (recall 58.18%). It never mistook LOW for HIGH or HIGH for LOW. Because missing a HIGH case is the most serious mistake, the dentist still checks every risk level. No dentist-checked cases were recorded during the study, because the clinic's patients were not screened, so the classifier's accuracy on real cases could not yet be measured; this is recommended in Chapter V.

### 4.2.4 Results Interface and Patient Records

To answer the second problem: every screening is now saved as a standard visual record. It contains the original photograph, colored boxes showing each finding with its name and confidence, a plain-language explanation of each condition, the risk score and level, the prevention plan, and the dentist's notes. The patient record lists all screenings by date with a risk trend chart, so visits can be compared, and each screening can be downloaded as a PDF report (Figure 25). Figures 17, 20, and 23 to 25 in Section 3.11 show these screens. Patients can also create their own portal account, where they see their latest risk level and how it changed since their last visit, their latest findings explained simply with the top next steps, a risk-over-time chart, the date of their next check-up (six months after the last screening), and their full screening history, but never another patient's data.

### 4.2.5 Role-Based Web Application

The staff side has three roles. The dentist is the administrator: the dentist can manage staff accounts and view the audit log. The receptionist registers and manages patients, and the dental assistant performs screenings. Patients have a separate login. The server checks each user's role on every request, not just by hiding menu buttons. Passwords are stored in scrambled (hashed) form, sign-ins use secure tokens, repeated login and chatbot requests are limited, and important staff actions are recorded in an audit log to which records are only added, never changed.

Staff and patients sign in with their email and password. Ticking “Remember me on this device” keeps them signed in for 30 days; otherwise they are signed out when the

browser closes. A user who forgets the password can reset it without email: staff confirm their email and the PRC license number on their account, and patients confirm their email, birthdate, and mobile number, and then choose a new password on the same page. A wrong answer always shows the same message, so nobody can use the form to find out which accounts exist; attempts are limited to five per minute, and every attempt is recorded in the audit log. An earlier version emailed a reset link, but the free server could not send email reliably, so that step was removed. Staff with no license number on file ask the dentist to reset their password. Signed-in users can also change their password from the sidebar or the portal header.

The system's server code is checked by 119 automated tests. They cover signing in, password recovery, the braces filter, the chatbot, staff accounts, the condition list, the detection models, patient records, the prevention plan, the risk score, user roles, and screenings, including restoring photographs from the database. All 119 tests passed (Table 28).

**Table 28 Automated Backend Test Results**

| Test module | Area tested | Test cases | Result |
|---|---|---|---|
| test_auth.py | Staff and patient login, tokens | 11 | Passed |
| test_braces_filter.py | Removal of orthodontic brackets from detections | 4 | Passed |
| test_chatbot.py | AI assistant retries, fallbacks, and verified clinic facts | 6 | Passed |
| test_dentists.py | Staff account management | 14 | Passed |
| test_labels.py | Class list consistency | 11 | Passed |
| test_onnx_yolo.py | ONNX Runtime letterboxing, NMS, and model loading | 4 | Passed |
| test_password_recovery.py | Remember me, forgot-password verification, and change password | 15 | Passed |
| test_patients.py | Patient records | 10 | Passed |
| test_recommender.py | KNN tier and prevention plan | 12 | Passed |
| test_risk_engine.py | Risk score and tier | 9 | Passed |
| test_roles.py | Three-role access control | 11 | Passed |

| Test module | Area tested | Test cases | Result |
|---|---|---|---|
| test_screenings.py | Screening workflow, storage, and photo restore | 12 | Passed |
| Total | | 119 | 119 passed, 0 failed |

*Source: python -m pytest in backend/ (run with YOLO_BACKEND=onnx on 29 October 2026).*

### 4.2.6 AI Chatbot

The public website has an AI assistant, powered by Google Gemini, that answers general questions about dental care, the clinic, and Toothwise. Before a question is sent to Gemini, email addresses, phone numbers, and record numbers are removed, and any request for personal records or screening results is pointed to the secure patient portal instead. Each user can send up to 12 questions per minute. When the free Gemini quota runs out, questions about the clinic (hours, location, services, and prices) are still answered from the clinic's verified information, and other questions get a “temporarily unavailable” message.

### 4.2.7 Web Performance and Accessibility

The website's public pages were tested with Google Lighthouse, a free tool that scores speed, accessibility, and good practice from 0 to 100, on both a phone-sized screen (with a slow connection) and a desktop screen. Because the home page was redesigned after the first test, all six tests were run again on October 20, 2026. Table 29 shows the scores.

**Table 29 Lighthouse Audit Results**

| Page | Viewport | Performance | Accessibility | Best practices | Largest Contentful Paint |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Landing | Desktop | 100 | 100 | 100 | 0.7 s |
| Landing | Mobile | 86 | 100 | 100 | 2.5 s |
| Staff login | Desktop | 99 | 100 | 100 | 0.9 s |
| Staff login | Mobile | 98 | 100 | 100 | 2.2 s |
| Patient portal | Desktop | 99 | 100 | 100 | 0.9 s |
| Patient portal | Mobile | 97 | 100 | 100 | 2.4 s |

*Landing (mobile) is the median of three runs (67, 86, 92); other rows are single runs. Cumulative Layout Shift was at most 0.014 on every page.*

Accessibility and best practices scored a perfect 100 on every page. Speed scored 99 to 100 on desktop and 86 to 98 on phones. The lowest, the home page on a phone, is caused by the amount of code and pictures the redesigned page loads; its score also changed the most between runs. Splitting the website's code into smaller parts cut the main download from 231 KB to 95 KB. The staff pages, which Lighthouse cannot open because they need a login, were checked separately with axe-core against the WCAG 2.0 and 2.1 accessibility rules (Levels A and AA) on all eight staff pages and five pop-up windows, in both light and dark mode; no problems were found.

### 4.3 Software Quality Evaluation Based on ISO/IEC 25010

This section answers the fourth problem: how acceptable is Toothwise to the people who used it? 103 respondents answered the online questionnaire (Google Forms) from October 19 to 28, 2026, after agreeing to take part. None of them was a patient of CodiSmile Dental Clinic, and no clinic records were used.

#### 4.3.1 Respondents

The respondents were in two groups (Table 30): 98 patient respondents, who tried the system from a patient's point of view, and 5 IT experts. Different parts of the questionnaire were meant for different groups, so not every section was answered by the same number of people (Table 31).

**Table 30 Distribution of Respondents**

| Respondent group | Frequency | Percentage |
|---|---|---|
| Patient respondents | 98 | 95.15% |
| IT experts / IT practitioners | 5 | 4.85% |
| Total | 103 | 100.00% |

**Table 31 Respondents per Questionnaire Section**

| Questionnaire section | Patient respondents | IT experts | Total |
|---|---|---|---|
| Current Manual Screening Process | 2 | 0 | 2 |
| Screening Consistency and Time | 2 | 0 | 2 |
| Security | 7 | 5 | 12 |
| Privacy | 7 | 5 | 12 |
| Usability | 7 | 5 | 12 |
| Reliability | 7 | 5 | 12 |
| Performance Efficiency | 7 | 5 | 12 |
| Data Protection | 7 | 5 | 12 |
| AI Detection and Risk Classification | 98 | 5 | 103 |
| Results Interface and Patient Records | 98 | 5 | 103 |
| KNN-Based Personalized Prevention Plan | 98 | 5 | 103 |

All 103 respondents rated the system's three main features: AI detection and risk classification, the results and patient records, and the prevention plan. The six ISO/IEC 25010 quality sections (Part B3) were meant only for dentists, clinic staff, and IT experts, as the form's instructions say, because they ask about staff-side features that patients never see, such as user roles, the staff audit log, and how records stay consistent. All 5 IT experts answered them. No dentist or clinic staff member took part, so the only other answers came from 7 patient respondents who answered the part anyway, for a total of 12. The two sections on the manual screening process and on screening consistency and time were answered by 2 respondents. Of the respondents who gave their work experience, 8 reported less than 1 year, 2 reported 1-3 years.

### 4.3.2 Evaluation Results per Quality Characteristic

Tables 32 to 37 show the results for the six quality characteristics, rated by 12 respondents. In each table, WM is the average rating (4 = Strongly Agree, 1 = Strongly Disagree), and SD shows how much the answers varied: a small SD means the respondents mostly agreed with one another.

**Table 32 Evaluation Results for Security**

| Code | Statement | WM | SD | Verbal interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| SE1 | Only authorized users can log in and access the system's functions. | 3.67 | 0.47 | Strongly Agree |
| SE2 | Each role (Dentist, Receptionist, Dental Assistant, Patient) can only access the features permitted for that role. | 3.67 | 0.47 | Strongly Agree |
| SE3 | Passwords and login sessions are handled securely. | 3.75 | 0.43 | Strongly Agree |
| SE4 | Sensitive staff actions are recorded in the audit log for administrative review. | 3.67 | 0.47 | Strongly Agree |
| | Security — mean | 3.69 | 0.46 | Strongly Agree |

*N = 12 (5 IT experts, 7 patient respondents). WM = weighted mean; SD = standard deviation.*

Security received an average rating of 3.69 out of 4 (SD 0.46), which means Strongly Agree. The best-rated statement was SE3, “Passwords and login sessions are handled securely” (3.75). The lowest was SE4, “Sensitive staff actions are recorded in the audit log for administrative review” (3.67), which is still Strongly Agree. IT experts gave lower ratings than patient respondents (3.45 against 3.86). Nobody disagreed with any statement in this section. One respondent suggested an extra security step for staff accounts, which is included in the recommendations.

**Table 33 Evaluation Results for Privacy**

| Code | Statement | WM | SD | Verbal interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| PR1 | Screening images are not publicly exposed and can only be viewed by authorized users. | 3.75 | 0.43 | Strongly Agree |
| PR2 | Patients can only view their own records through the patient portal. | 3.75 | 0.43 | Strongly Agree |
| PR3 | The system handles personal and health information in line with the Data Privacy Act of 2012. | 3.67 | 0.47 | Strongly Agree |
| | Privacy — mean | 3.72 | 0.45 | Strongly Agree |

*N = 12 (5 IT experts, 7 patient respondents). WM = weighted mean; SD = standard deviation.*

Privacy received an average rating of 3.72 out of 4 (SD 0.45), which means Strongly Agree. The best-rated statement was PR1, “Screening images are not publicly exposed and can only be viewed by authorized users” (3.75). The lowest was PR3, “The

system handles personal and health information in line with the Data Privacy Act of 2012" (3.67), which is still Strongly Agree. IT experts gave lower ratings than patient respondents (3.53 against 3.86). Nobody disagreed with any statement in this section.

**Table 34 Evaluation Results for Usability**

| Code | Statement | WM | SD | Verbal interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| US1 | The system is easy to learn and use, even for first-time users. | 3.67 | 0.47 | Strongly Agree |
| US2 | Navigation between the dashboard, patient records, and screening pages is clear and logical. | 3.67 | 0.47 | Strongly Agree |
| US3 | Labels, buttons, and messages are easy to understand. | 3.83 | 0.37 | Strongly Agree |
| US4 | The layout and design of the interface are visually pleasing and organized. | 3.67 | 0.47 | Strongly Agree |
| | Usability — mean | 3.71 | 0.45 | Strongly Agree |

*N = 12 (5 IT experts, 7 patient respondents). WM = weighted mean; SD = standard deviation.*

Usability received an average rating of 3.71 out of 4 (SD 0.45), which means Strongly Agree. The best-rated statement was US3, "Labels, buttons, and messages are easy to understand" (3.83). The lowest was US4, "The layout and design of the interface are visually pleasing and organized" (3.67), which is still Strongly Agree. IT experts gave lower ratings than patient respondents (3.50 against 3.86). Nobody disagreed with any statement in this section. In the written comments, ease of use and the look of the interface were praised most, while a few respondents found some pages too long or some features hard to find.

**Table 35 Evaluation Results for Reliability**

| Code | Statement | WM | SD | Verbal interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| RE1 | The system runs consistently without unexpected crashes or failures. | 3.50 | 0.50 | Strongly Agree |
| RE2 | When an error occurs, the system shows a clear message and recovers without losing data. | 3.75 | 0.43 | Strongly Agree |
| RE3 | The system produces consistent results when the same image is screened again. | 3.58 | 0.49 | Strongly Agree |
| | Reliability — mean | 3.61 | 0.49 | Strongly Agree |

*N = 12 (5 IT experts, 7 patient respondents). WM = weighted mean; SD = standard deviation.*

Reliability received an average rating of 3.61 out of 4 (SD 0.49), which means Strongly Agree. The best-rated statement was RE2, “When an error occurs, the system shows a clear message and recovers without losing data” (3.75). The lowest was RE1, “The system runs consistently without unexpected crashes or failures” (3.50), which is still Strongly Agree. IT experts gave lower ratings than patient respondents (3.27 against 3.86). Nobody disagreed with any statement in this section. IT experts also rated RE1 lowest. In the written comments, two respondents mentioned slow first loading and bugs that had to be fixed; one reason is that the free server used for the study goes to sleep after 15 minutes without use and takes time to wake up (Chapter I, Limitations).

**Table 36 Evaluation Results for Performance Efficiency**

| Code | Statement | WM | SD | Verbal interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| PE1 | The system analyzes an uploaded image and displays the results within an acceptable time. | 3.67 | 0.47 | Strongly Agree |
| PE2 | Pages and patient records load quickly. | 3.67 | 0.47 | Strongly Agree |
| PE3 | The system remains responsive while performing AI detection. | 3.67 | 0.47 | Strongly Agree |
| | Performance Efficiency — mean | 3.67 | 0.47 | Strongly Agree |

*N = 12 (5 IT experts, 7 patient respondents). WM = weighted mean; SD = standard deviation.*

Performance Efficiency received an average rating of 3.67 out of 4 (SD 0.47), which means Strongly Agree. Every statement in this section received the same average. IT experts gave lower ratings than patient respondents (3.40 against 3.86). Nobody disagreed with any statement in this section.

Data Protection received an average rating of 3.69 out of 4 (SD 0.46), which means Strongly Agree. The best-rated statement was DP1, “Patient, screening, and detection records are stored accurately and completely” (3.75). The lowest was DP2, “Related records (patients, screenings, findings, recommendations, notes) remain consistent with one another” (3.58), which is still Strongly Agree. IT experts gave lower

ratings than patient respondents (3.47 against 3.86). Nobody disagreed with any statement in this section.

**Table 37 Evaluation Results for Data Protection**

| Code | Statement | WM | SD | Verbal interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| DP1 | Patient, screening, and detection records are stored accurately and completely. | 3.75 | 0.43 | Strongly Agree |
| DP2 | Related records (patients, screenings, findings, recommendations, notes) remain consistent with one another. | 3.58 | 0.49 | Strongly Agree |
| DP3 | The system prevents invalid or incomplete data from being saved. | 3.75 | 0.43 | Strongly Agree |
| | Data Protection — mean | 3.69 | 0.46 | Strongly Agree |

*N = 12 (5 IT experts, 7 patient respondents). WM = weighted mean; SD = standard deviation.*

### 4.3.3 Evaluation Results for the System Features

Tables 38 to 40 show the results for the system's three main features, rated by all 103 respondents.

**Table 38 Evaluation Results for AI Detection and Risk Classification**

| Code | Statement | WM | SD | Verbal interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| AD1 | Toothwise accurately detects tartar, plaque, cavity, gum inflammation, and healthy tooth from a still intraoral photograph. | 3.48 | 0.54 | Strongly Agree |
| AD2 | Combining the YOLOv8 and YOLOv12 outputs produces dependable detection results. | 3.43 | 0.53 | Strongly Agree |
| AD3 | The computed risk score and risk classification (Low, Medium, High) reflect the detected findings appropriately. | 3.50 | 0.50 | Strongly Agree |
| AD4 | The system works well with photos taken using a standard device camera such as a smartphone or webcam. | 3.47 | 0.52 | Strongly Agree |
| AD5 | The detection results are a helpful reference that supports, but does not replace, the dentist's judgment. | 3.40 | 0.56 | Strongly Agree |
| | AI Detection and Risk Classification — mean | 3.45 | 0.53 | Strongly Agree |

*N = 103 (5 IT experts, 98 patient respondents). WM = weighted mean; SD = standard deviation.*

AI Detection and Risk Classification received an average rating of 3.45 out of 4 (SD 0.53), which means Strongly Agree. The best-rated statement was AD3, “The computed risk score and risk classification (Low, Medium, High) reflect the detected findings appropriately” (3.50), and the lowest was AD5, “The detection results are a helpful reference that supports, but does not replace, the dentist's judgment” (3.40). Only 9 of the 515 answers in this section were Disagree or Strongly Disagree. Note that this rating shows how accurate the detection seemed to the respondents, not how accurate it measured: the measured accuracy in Section 4.1 is moderate, and plaque is often missed. One respondent wrote that results may be wrong when the photograph is blurry and should still be checked by a dentist, which is how the system is meant to be used.

**Table 39 Evaluation Results for Results Interface and Patient Records**

| Code | Statement | WM | SD | Verbal interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| RI1 | The bounding boxes and condition labels clearly show where each finding is located on the image. | 3.49 | 0.50 | Strongly Agree |
| RI2 | The plain-language descriptions make the findings easy to understand. | 3.45 | 0.52 | Strongly Agree |
| RI3 | The per-patient record makes it easy to review and compare findings across visits. | 3.48 | 0.54 | Strongly Agree |
| RI4 | The downloadable PDF screening report is complete and useful for clinical recordkeeping. | 3.47 | 0.55 | Strongly Agree |
| RI5 | The self-service patient portal lets patients conveniently view their own screening history and past findings. | 3.48 | 0.59 | Strongly Agree |
| | Results Interface and Patient Records — mean | 3.47 | 0.54 | Strongly Agree |

*N = 103 (5 IT experts, 98 patient respondents). WM = weighted mean; SD = standard deviation.*

Results Interface and Patient Records received an average rating of 3.47 out of 4 (SD 0.54), which means Strongly Agree. The best-rated statement was RI1, “The bounding boxes and condition labels clearly show where each finding is located on the image” (3.49), and the lowest was RI2, “The plain-language descriptions make the findings easy to understand” (3.45). Only 7 of the 515 answers in this section were

Disagree or Strongly Disagree. In their written comments, respondents especially liked the plain-language explanations and how clearly the results are shown.

**Table 40 Evaluation Results for KNN-Based Personalized Prevention Plan**

| Code | Statement | WM | SD | Verbal interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| PP1 | The prevention plan is relevant to the patient's detected findings and risk classification. | 3.54 | 0.50 | Strongly Agree |
| PP2 | The recommendations are clear and easy for patients to follow. | 3.47 | 0.52 | Strongly Agree |
| PP3 | The prevention plan encourages earlier preventive action and better oral health awareness. | 3.51 | 0.52 | Strongly Agree |
| PP4 | The prevention plan appropriately serves as guidance and not as a formal medical prescription. | 3.49 | 0.50 | Strongly Agree |
| | KNN-Based Personalized Prevention Plan — mean | 3.50 | 0.51 | Strongly Agree |

*N = 103 (5 IT experts, 98 patient respondents). WM = weighted mean; SD = standard deviation.*

KNN-Based Personalized Prevention Plan received an average rating of 3.50 out of 4 (SD 0.51), which means Strongly Agree. The best-rated statement was PP1, “The prevention plan is relevant to the patient's detected findings and risk classification” (3.54), and the lowest was PP2, “The recommendations are clear and easy for patients to follow” (3.47). Only 2 of the 412 answers in this section were Disagree or Strongly Disagree. This was the best-rated of the three features. Respondents wrote that the tips were clear and reminded them to care for their teeth, and several asked for more dental tips, check-up reminders, and short videos.

### 4.3.4 Summary of the Evaluation

**Table 41 Summary of Evaluation Results**

| Section | IT experts (WM) | Patient respondents (WM) | Overall WM | SD | Interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Security | 3.45 | 3.86 | 3.69 | 0.46 | Highly Acceptable |
| Privacy | 3.53 | 3.86 | 3.72 | 0.45 | Highly Acceptable |
| Usability | 3.50 | 3.86 | 3.71 | 0.45 | Highly |

| Section | IT experts (WM) | Patient respondents (WM) | Overall WM | SD | Interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | Acceptable |
| Reliability | 3.27 | 3.86 | 3.61 | 0.49 | Highly Acceptable |
| Performance Efficiency | 3.40 | 3.86 | 3.67 | 0.47 | Highly Acceptable |
| Data Protection | 3.47 | 3.86 | 3.69 | 0.46 | Highly Acceptable |
| AI Detection and Risk Classification | 3.36 | 3.46 | 3.45 | 0.53 | Highly Acceptable |
| Results Interface and Patient Records | 3.36 | 3.48 | 3.47 | 0.54 | Highly Acceptable |
| KNN-Based Personalized Prevention Plan | 3.35 | 3.51 | 3.50 | 0.51 | Highly Acceptable |
| Quality characteristics (mean of six) | | | 3.68 | 0.47 | Highly Acceptable |
| System features (mean of three) | | | 3.48 | 0.53 | Highly Acceptable |

*Quality characteristics: N = 12; system features: N = 103.*

All nine sections were rated Strongly Agree, so Toothwise is Highly Acceptable to its respondents. The six quality characteristics averaged 3.68 out of 4, and the three features 3.48. Among the quality characteristics, Privacy was rated highest (3.72) and Reliability lowest (3.61). IT experts gave lower ratings than patient respondents in every section, but still Strongly Agree; this is expected, because IT experts judge the system against technical standards. Disagreement was rare: 0 of 240 quality answers and 18 of 1442 feature answers were Disagree or Strongly Disagree.

Two cautions apply. First, only 12 of the 103 respondents rated the six quality characteristics, and only 5 were IT experts, so these ratings come from a small group. This is because that part was meant for dentists, clinic staff, and IT experts, and no dentists or clinic staff took part. Second, the ratings show what the respondents thought of the system; they should be read together with the measured results in Sections 4.1 and 4.2.

In the written comments, respondents most often praised how easy the system is to use, its clear design, and its simple explanations. The problems they mentioned were slow loading the first time, pages with too much information at once, some features being hard to find, and wrong results from blurry photographs. Their suggestions were reminders for brushing and check-ups, more dental tips and short videos, an easier search, more conditions to detect with better accuracy, and an extra security step for staff accounts.

### 4.4 Screening Consistency and Screening Time

This section answers the fifth problem: does Toothwise make screening more consistent and faster? The original plan was to time the same patients' screenings with and without Toothwise and compare both with the dentist's findings, but this could not be done because the study did not involve the clinic's patients. Instead, this section uses the respondents' ratings of the current manual process and of Toothwise (Tables 42 and 43), together with the measured processing time in Section 4.1.6.

**Table 42 Respondents' Assessment of the Current Manual Screening Process**

| Code | Statement | WM | SD | Verbal interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| MS1 | Early-stage tartar, plaque, cavity, and gum inflammation are difficult to detect consistently through visual inspection alone. | 3.00 | 0.00 | Agree |
| MS2 | Findings from visual-only screening can differ between examinations of the same patient. | 3.50 | 0.50 | Strongly Agree |
| MS3 | Lighting, viewing angle, and condition stage affect how reliably dental conditions are identified by eye. | 3.50 | 0.50 | Strongly Agree |
| MS4 | The clinic lacks a standardized visual record of screening findings that can be compared across visits. | 3.00 | 0.00 | Agree |
| MS5 | Patients currently have no convenient way to review their own screening history. | 3.50 | 0.50 | Strongly Agree |
| MS6 | Patients rarely receive preventive guidance that is specific to their own screening findings. | 2.50 | 0.50 | Disagree |
| MS7 | A tool that supports consistent early screening would be useful to the clinic. | 3.50 | 0.50 | Strongly Agree |
| | Current Manual Screening Process — mean | 3.21 | 0.56 | Agree |

*N = 2. These two sections were answered by only 2 respondents, so the results are shown for completeness and should not be generalized.*

**Table 43 Respondents' Assessment of Screening Consistency and Time with Toothwise**

| Code | Statement | WM | SD | Verbal interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| SC1 | Toothwise makes screening results more consistent than the manual visual-only process. | 3.50 | 0.50 | Strongly Agree |
| SC2 | Toothwise reduces the time needed to complete and document a screening. | 3.50 | 0.50 | Strongly Agree |
| SC3 | Toothwise's findings agree well with the dentist's own findings. | 3.50 | 0.50 | Strongly Agree |
| SC4 | Toothwise fits smoothly into the clinic's existing screening workflow. | 3.00 | 0.00 | Agree |
| SC5 | I would recommend the continued use of Toothwise at CodiSmile Dental Clinic. | 3.50 | 0.50 | Strongly Agree |
| | Screening Consistency and Time — mean | 3.40 | 0.49 | Strongly Agree |

*N = 2. These two sections were answered by only 2 respondents, so the results are shown for completeness and should not be generalized.*

The 2 respondents agreed that checking teeth by eye alone has the problems described in the first problem (average 3.21): results can differ from one examination to the next, lighting and angle affect what can be seen, and a tool for consistent early screening would be useful. The only statement they disagreed with was MS6, “Patients rarely receive preventive guidance that is specific to their own screening findings” (2.50). They also agreed that Toothwise makes results more consistent, saves time in completing and recording a screening, and agrees with the dentist's own findings (average 3.40), and they would recommend that the clinic keep using it.

Because only 2 respondents answered these sections and no screening was timed, these results show a likely direction, not a measured effect. What was measured is the processing time: the live system finishes a screening with both models in about 3 to 4 seconds (Section 4.1.6), and it records every finding, the risk result, and the prevention plan automatically, so the screening no longer has to be written up by hand.

# CHAPTER V

# SUMMARY OF FINDINGS, CONCLUSIONS, AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This chapter summarizes the findings of the study, states the conclusions drawn from them, and presents recommendations for CodiSmile Dental Clinic, for the further development of Toothwise, and for future researchers.

## 5.1 Summary of Findings

The findings are summarized according to the five problems stated in Chapter I.

1. **Detection of the five conditions (Problem 1).** YOLOv8 and YOLOv12 were trained on 40,271 images merged from four public datasets and tested on 2,930 unseen images. On the test split, YOLOv8 obtained a precision of 54.32%, a recall of 52.34%, and an mAP@50 of 51.91%; YOLOv12 obtained 52.94%, 50.06%, and 48.11%, with about 24% fewer parameters and slightly faster inference (about 206 ms against 216 ms per image on CPU). Fusing the two models raised the mAP@50 to 54.24%. Healthy tooth and cavity were detected best, and plaque worst (mAP@50 below 10%). Detection accuracy at the deployed threshold was 43.77% for YOLOv8, 41.85% for YOLOv12, and 43.02% for the ensemble. In the deployed system, a screening takes about 3 to 4 seconds, and metal brackets are filtered out so that they are not reported as cavities. The respondents who evaluated the current manual process agreed that it has the limitations described in the first problem (mean 3.21).
2. **Recording and access to findings (Problem 2).** Every screening is saved as a standardized visual record with the photograph, labeled bounding boxes, the risk result, the prevention plan, and the dentist's notes; it can be compared across visits, exported as a PDF report, and viewed by the patient through the self-service portal, which now also shows the latest results, a risk-over-time chart,

and the next check-up date. Respondents rated the results interface and patient records 3.47, Strongly Agree.

3. **Finding-specific preventive guidance (Problem 3).** The rule-based risk engine and the KNN classifier (K = 5) produce a risk tier and an ordered prevention plan for every screening. On 2,000 unseen synthetic cases, the classifier reproduced the clinical rule with 92.75% accuracy; its weakest tier was HIGH (recall 58.18%). Respondents rated the prevention plan 3.50, Strongly Agree, the highest of the three feature sections.
4. **Acceptability (Problem 4).** On the six quality characteristics, answered by 12 respondents, the overall mean was 3.68 (Highly Acceptable), with Privacy highest (3.72) and Reliability lowest (3.61). The three feature sections, answered by all 103 respondents, obtained an overall mean of 3.48 (Highly Acceptable). IT experts rated every section lower than patient respondents, but still Strongly Agree. Technically, the web application scored 100 in Lighthouse accessibility and best practices on all audited pages and passed all 119 automated backend tests.
5. **Screening consistency and time (Problem 5).** A controlled, timed comparison against the dentist's findings was not conducted. The 2 respondents who answered the related section agreed that Toothwise makes screening more consistent and faster to document (mean 3.40), and the measured processing time of the deployed system is about 3 to 4 seconds per screening.

## 5.2 Conclusions

Based on the findings, the following conclusions are drawn.

1. YOLO-based detection on ordinary intraoral photographs can locate and label tartar, plaque, cavity, gum inflammation, and healthy tooth, but with an mAP@50 of about 52% to 54% on unseen images and large differences between

conditions, it is suitable as a screening aid that directs the dentist's attention, not as an independent diagnosis. This confirms the delimitation set in Chapter I.

2. The difference between YOLOv8 and YOLOv12 is small compared with the differences between conditions, so the quality, balance, and consistency of the training data matter more than the choice of architecture. Combining both models improved detection over either model alone, which supports the ensemble design.
3. Storing each screening as a standardized visual record, with patient portal access, addresses the absence of comparable records across visits identified in the second problem.
4. Finding-specific prevention plans can be generated automatically for every screening without adding to the dentist's work, and the respondents found them relevant and easy to follow.
5. Toothwise is highly acceptable to its evaluators on all six quality characteristics and on its main features (overall means of 3.68 and 3.48 on a four-point scale). Because the quality characteristics were intended for dentists, clinic staff, and IT experts and were rated by 12 respondents, of whom 5 were IT experts, this conclusion should be confirmed with a larger group of IT experts, dentists, and clinic staff.
6. Toothwise shortens the documentation of a screening, since results, risk, and the prevention plan are produced and recorded in seconds, and the respondents expect it to make screening more consistent. Whether it improves agreement with the dentist and shortens the whole screening in practice could not be established without a controlled comparison.

### 5.3 Recommendations

In light of the findings and conclusions, the following are recommended.

**For CodiSmile Dental Clinic**

1. Use Toothwise as a screening and documentation aid, always with the dentist's review of the detections and confirmation of the risk tier, and take clear, well-lit photographs, since blurry images reduce accuracy.
2. Confirm or correct the risk tier of every screening so that the KNN classifier is retrained on real, dentist-labeled cases.
3. Move the system from the free hosting tier to a plan that does not sleep, so that the first page load is not delayed, before using it in daily operations.

**For the further development of Toothwise**

1. Improve detection of plaque and other weak classes by adding more and better-annotated photographs, including consented photographs from the clinic, and add a braces class instead of filtering brackets.
2. Add the features requested by respondents: reminders for brushing and check-ups, more dental health tips and short videos, a faster and simpler search, and lighter pages for slow Internet connections.
3. Add a second authentication factor for staff accounts, as one respondent suggested, and keep the audit and privacy controls aligned with the Data Privacy Act of 2012.
4. Simplify pages that present much information at once and make less-used features easier to find.

**For future researchers**

1. Conduct the controlled comparison planned for the fifth problem: time the same screenings with and without Toothwise and measure agreement with the dentist's findings (for example, with Cohen's kappa).

2. Repeat the ISO/IEC 25010 evaluation with a larger and more balanced group of IT experts, dentists, and clinic staff, the groups for which the quality evaluation was designed.
3. Validate the models on photographs from other clinics and devices, and compare them with newer detection architectures and with segmentation-based approaches.
4. Train the detection models on more and larger datasets. The current models learned from four public datasets in which plaque appears in only one source, which explains much of the weak plaque result. More public datasets, consented and dentist-annotated clinic photographs, and a more balanced number of examples per condition should raise accuracy.
5. Add an oral diagnosis form to the system: a digital examination form in which the dentist records the clinical findings for each tooth (for example, on a tooth chart), the final diagnosis, and the treatment plan, next to the AI detections. The recorded diagnoses could then be compared with the detections to measure accuracy in real use and supply labeled cases for retraining.
6. Extend the system to detect more classes. The source datasets already contain conditions that this study left out, such as missing teeth, malalignment, spacing, tooth stains and discoloration, oral ulcers, and hypodontia, and orthodontic braces could be added as their own class instead of being filtered out. Each new class needs enough annotated examples, a risk weight, and its own advice.
7. Use an intraoral camera to capture the images for detection. Smartphone photographs vary in lighting and angle and cannot clearly show the back teeth; an intraoral camera gives close, well-lit, and consistent views of each tooth. Future researchers could connect one to the screening page and retrain the models on its images.

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## APPENDIX A

### Evaluation Questionnaire

The questionnaire was answered online through Google Forms. Each statement was rated on a four-point scale: Strongly Agree (4), Agree (3), Disagree (2), and Strongly Disagree (1).

**Part A. Current Process and Expected Effect**

*Current Manual Screening Process*

- MS1. Early-stage tartar, plaque, cavity, and gum inflammation are difficult to detect consistently through visual inspection alone.
- MS2. Findings from visual-only screening can differ between examinations of the same patient.
- MS3. Lighting, viewing angle, and condition stage affect how reliably dental conditions are identified by eye.
- MS4. The clinic lacks a standardized visual record of screening findings that can be compared across visits.
- MS5. Patients currently have no convenient way to review their own screening history.
- MS6. Patients rarely receive preventive guidance that is specific to their own screening findings.
- MS7. A tool that supports consistent early screening would be useful to the clinic.

*Screening Consistency and Time*

- SC1. Toothwise makes screening results more consistent than the manual visual-only process.
- SC2. Toothwise reduces the time needed to complete and document a screening.
- SC3. Toothwise's findings agree well with the dentist's own findings.
- SC4. Toothwise fits smoothly into the clinic's existing screening workflow.
- SC5. I would recommend the continued use of Toothwise at CodiSmile Dental Clinic.

**Part B3. Software Quality Evaluation (ISO/IEC 25010) — for dentists, clinic staff, and IT experts**

*Security*

- SE1. Only authorized users can log in and access the system's functions.
- SE2. Each role (Dentist, Receptionist, Dental Assistant, Patient) can only access the features permitted for that role.
- SE3. Passwords and login sessions are handled securely.
- SE4. Sensitive staff actions are recorded in the audit log for administrative review.

*Privacy*

- PR1. Screening images are not publicly exposed and can only be viewed by authorized users.
- PR2. Patients can only view their own records through the patient portal.
- PR3. The system handles personal and health information in line with the Data Privacy Act of 2012.

*Usability*

- US1. The system is easy to learn and use, even for first-time users.
- US2. Navigation between the dashboard, patient records, and screening pages is clear and logical.
- US3. Labels, buttons, and messages are easy to understand.
- US4. The layout and design of the interface are visually pleasing and organized.

*Reliability*

- RE1. The system runs consistently without unexpected crashes or failures.
- RE2. When an error occurs, the system shows a clear message and recovers without losing data.
- RE3. The system produces consistent results when the same image is screened again.

*Performance Efficiency*

- PE1. The system analyzes an uploaded image and displays the results within an acceptable time.
- PE2. Pages and patient records load quickly.
- PE3. The system remains responsive while performing AI detection.

*Data Protection*

- DP1. Patient, screening, and detection records are stored accurately and completely.

- DP2. Related records (patients, screenings, findings, recommendations, notes) remain consistent with one another.
- DP3. The system prevents invalid or incomplete data from being saved.

**Part B. System Features — for all respondents**

*AI Detection and Risk Classification*

- AD1. Toothwise accurately detects tartar, plaque, cavity, gum inflammation, and healthy tooth from a still intraoral photograph.
- AD2. Combining the YOLOv8 and YOLOv12 outputs produces dependable detection results.
- AD3. The computed risk score and risk classification (Low, Medium, High) reflect the detected findings appropriately.
- AD4. The system works well with photos taken using a standard device camera such as a smartphone or webcam.
- AD5. The detection results are a helpful reference that supports, but does not replace, the dentist's judgment.

*Results Interface and Patient Records*

- RI1. The bounding boxes and condition labels clearly show where each finding is located on the image.
- RI2. The plain-language descriptions make the findings easy to understand.
- RI3. The per-patient record makes it easy to review and compare findings across visits.
- RI4. The downloadable PDF screening report is complete and useful for clinical recordkeeping.
- RI5. The self-service patient portal lets patients conveniently view their own screening history and past findings.

*KNN-Based Personalized Prevention Plan*

- PP1. The prevention plan is relevant to the patient's detected findings and risk classification.
- PP2. The recommendations are clear and easy for patients to follow.
- PP3. The prevention plan encourages earlier preventive action and better oral health awareness.
- PP4. The prevention plan appropriately serves as guidance and not as a formal medical prescription.

**Part C. Open-ended Questions**

- What did you like most about Toothwise?
- What problems or difficulties did you encounter while using Toothwise?
- What improvements or additional features would you suggest?

## APPENDIX B

### Frequency Distribution of Responses

The table lists, for every statement, how many respondents chose each rating, the number of respondents who answered it (N), and the weighted mean (WM). Respondent names are not included.

**Table 44 Frequency Distribution of Responses per Statement**

| Code | Strongly Agree (4) | Agree (3) | Disagree (2) | Strongly Disagree (1) | N | WM | Section |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| MS1 | 0 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 3.00 | MS |
| MS2 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 3.50 | MS |
| MS3 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 3.50 | MS |
| MS4 | 0 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 3.00 | MS |
| MS5 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 3.50 | MS |
| MS6 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 2 | 2.50 | MS |
| MS7 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 3.50 | MS |
| SC1 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 3.50 | SC |
| SC2 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 3.50 | SC |
| SC3 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 3.50 | SC |
| SC4 | 0 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 3.00 | SC |
| SC5 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 3.50 | SC |
| SE1 | 8 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.67 | SE |
| SE2 | 8 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.67 | SE |
| SE3 | 9 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.75 | SE |
| SE4 | 8 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.67 | SE |
| PR1 | 9 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.75 | PR |
| PR2 | 9 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.75 | PR |
| PR3 | 8 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.67 | PR |
| US1 | 8 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.67 | US |
| US2 | 8 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.67 | US |
| US3 | 10 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.83 | US |
| US4 | 8 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.67 | US |
| RE1 | 6 | 6 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.50 | RE |
| RE2 | 9 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.75 | RE |
| RE3 | 7 | 5 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.58 | RE |

| Code | Strongly Agree (4) | Agree (3) | Disagree (2) | Strongly Disagree (1) | N | WM | Section |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| PE1 | 8 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.67 | PE |
| PE2 | 8 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.67 | PE |
| PE3 | 8 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.67 | PE |
| DP1 | 9 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.75 | DP |
| DP2 | 7 | 5 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.58 | DP |
| DP3 | 9 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 3.75 | DP |
| AD1 | 51 | 50 | 2 | 0 | 103 | 3.48 | AD |
| AD2 | 46 | 55 | 2 | 0 | 103 | 3.43 | AD |
| AD3 | 52 | 51 | 0 | 0 | 103 | 3.50 | AD |
| AD4 | 49 | 53 | 1 | 0 | 103 | 3.47 | AD |
| AD5 | 45 | 54 | 4 | 0 | 103 | 3.40 | AD |
| RI1 | 50 | 53 | 0 | 0 | 103 | 3.49 | RI |
| RI2 | 47 | 55 | 1 | 0 | 103 | 3.45 | RI |
| RI3 | 51 | 50 | 2 | 0 | 103 | 3.48 | RI |
| RI4 | 50 | 52 | 0 | 1 | 103 | 3.47 | RI |
| RI5 | 53 | 47 | 2 | 1 | 103 | 3.48 | RI |
| PP1 | 56 | 47 | 0 | 0 | 103 | 3.54 | PP |
| PP2 | 49 | 53 | 1 | 0 | 103 | 3.47 | PP |
| PP3 | 54 | 48 | 1 | 0 | 103 | 3.51 | PP |
| PP4 | 50 | 53 | 0 | 0 | 103 | 3.49 | PP |

*Section codes: MS = Current Manual Screening Process; SC = Screening Consistency and Time; SE = Security; PR = Privacy; US = Usability; RE = Reliability; PE = Performance Efficiency; DP = Data Protection; AD = AI Detection and Risk Classification; RI = Results Interface and Patient Records; PP = KNN-Based Personalized Prevention Plan.*

## APPENDIX C

### Letter of Approval from CodiSmile Dental Clinic

October 26, 2026

**DRA. ANGELICA SHALA C. CODILLA**
Head Dentist
CodiSmile Dental Clinic
NW Phase LRT Central Terminal, Arroceros St.
Brgy. 659-A, Ermita, Manila City

Dear Dra. Codilla:

Greetings of peace!

We, the undersigned students of the College of Computing Studies, Universidad de Manila, are currently conducting our capstone project entitled **"Toothwise: A YOLO-Based Multi-Condition Dental Screening System with KNN-Based Recommendation for CodiSmile Dental Clinic."** The system analyzes still intraoral photographs to detect tartar, plaque, cavity, gum inflammation, and healthy tooth using the YOLOv8 and YOLOv12 object detection models, computes a risk classification, and generates a personalized prevention plan, while all findings remain subject to the review and final judgment of the clinic's licensed dentist.

In line with this, we respectfully request your approval to conduct our study at CodiSmile Dental Clinic, specifically to:

1. use CodiSmile Dental Clinic as the deployment site and clinical reference of the Toothwise system;
2. demonstrate and pilot the system with the clinic's dentist, dental assistants, and receptionist, using sample dental images only; and
3. consult the clinic's dentist on the system's detection results, risk classification, and prevention plans so that they reflect sound clinical practice.

The study does not involve the clinic's patients. The ISO/IEC 25010 software quality evaluation has already been answered by 50 respondents from outside the clinic, so no patient photograph, record, or personal information from CodiSmile Dental Clinic will be collected. Any information shared with us will be kept strictly confidential and used solely for academic purposes, in accordance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173), and all activities will be scheduled so as not to disrupt the clinic's daily operations.

**Figure 30 Letter Requesting Approval to Conduct the Study (page 1 of 2).**

Your approval will be a great help to the completion of our study. Thank you very much for your time and kind consideration.

Respectfully yours,

| | |
|---|---|
| _____ | _____ |
| **Brayan Axel L. Tubillas** | **Robin C. Ponce** |
| Proponent | Proponent |
| _____ | _____ |
| **Keith Ashly V. Sales** | **Rizelle Carla N. Magpantay** |
| Proponent | Proponent |

_____
**Reizen S. Arreola**
Proponent

Noted by:

_____
**PROF. FRANCIS ARLANDO L. ATIENZA**
Capstone Adviser, College of Computing Studies

Approved by:

_____
**DRA. ANGELICA SHALA C. CODILLA**
Head Dentist, CodiSmile Dental Clinic

Date: _____

☐ Approved
☐ Not approved

**Figure 31 Letter Requesting Approval to Conduct the Study (page 2 of 2).**